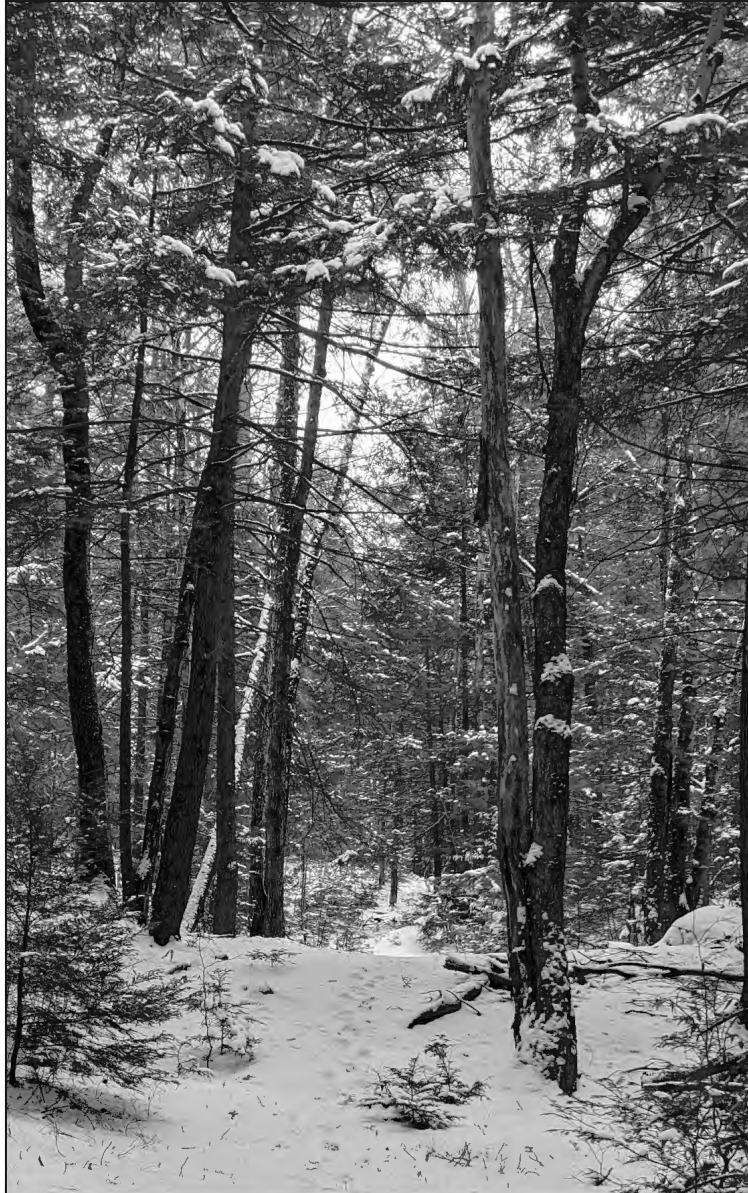


Town of Plainfield Annual Report 2022



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Jeanne Sargent

APPOINTED OFFICIALS FY 2022

Position	Appointee	Term Expires
Accountant Three Year	Paula J. King	2025
Americans with Disabilities Act Cmte One Year	Vacant	
	Vacant	
Agricultural Commission Three Year		
	Anna Hanchett	2024
	Bi-Sek Hsiao	2023
	Erin Kelly-Dill	2024
	Ed Stockman	2025
	Sarah Stull	2022
Alternate One Year	Charlie Carden	2023
Animal Control Officer One Year	Kate Nevins	2023
Animal Control Officer	Warren Kirkpatrick, Certified	2023
Board of Registrars Three Year		
	John F. Westwood	2023
	Linda J. Melle	2024
	Ruth Osgood	2025
	Robert Fusco	2025
Plainfield Police Working Group One Year <i>Disbanded</i>		
Building Committee Three Year		
<i>+Appointed by Moderator</i>	David Alvord	2023
<i>Appointed by Moderator</i>	Lilly Thompson	2021
<i>Appointed by Moderator</i>	Jeff Prost	2023
<i>Appointed by Select board</i>	Kathryn Jenson	2025
<i>Appointed by Finance Com.</i>	Peter LaPointe	2025
Burial Agent One Year	Ruth Osgood	2023
Carl Nilman Scholarship Committee Rep. One Year	Allen Irvine	2023
Cemetery Committee Three Year		
	Merton Taylor, Sr.	2025
	Theresa A. Thatcher	2024
	Ruth Osgood	2025
Conservation Commission Three Year		
	Judith B. Williams, Chair.	2023
	Judy Ferber	2023
	Eric Burcroff	2024
	John Burns	2023
	John Nelson	2023
	Alice Schertle	2025
CORI Officer One Year	On Hold	
Council on Aging Three Year		
	Shirley Todd Wood	2022
	Polly Ryan	2022
	Anne Irvine	2021
	Bonnie Phillips	2022
	Susan Pearson	2021
	Mary Potter	2022
Emergency Management One Year		
	Walter Jennings	2022
	David Alvord	2022
	Justin Litchfield	2022
Emergency Response Coordinator	Walter Jennings	2022

Fire Department One Year

<i>Fire Chief</i>	David W. Alvord, Chief/EMT	2022
<i>Appoints</i>	Duane Meehan, Asst.Chief	2021
<i>Fire Officers</i>	Matthew Hardwick, Captain	2021
	Rob Shearer, Lieutenant/EMT	2021
	Ellen Dupont	
	Lt./EMT/Med Officer	2021
	Jamie Wolodridge, Lieutenant	
	Andy Stevens, Lieutenant	2021
Flags & Flowers Committee One Year		
	Linda Mason	2022
	Sandra J. Morann	2022
	Bonnie Phillips	2022
Franklin Regional Transit Authority One Year		
	Ben Gillett	2023
Geneologist One Year	Betsey Howe	2023
Grant Writing Committee Three Year		
	Kimberly Longley	2023
	2 Vacancies	
Hazardous Materials Officer One Year	David Alvord	2023
Highland Ambulance - Town Rep. Three Year	Ed Morann	2023
Highland Valley Elder Services One Year	Vacant	
Hilltown Community Development Corporation Rep. One Year	Vacant	
Hilltown Resource Management Cooperative One Year	Vacant	
	John Nelson, (Recycling Coord)	2022
Historical Commission Three Year		
	Judy A. Williams, Chair.	2024
	Lori Austin	2024
	Matthew Stowell	2024
	Dudley Williams	2025
	Dario Coletta	2023
Inspector of Gas Fittings One Year	Donald Lawton	2023
Inspector of Plumbing One Year	Donald Lawton	2023
Inspector of Wiring One Year	David Rhinemiller	2023
IT Director One Year	Vacant	
Building Inspector	Charlie Baiardi	
Assistant Building Inspector	Robert Walden	6/30/23
Master Street Address Guide Cmte. One Year		
	Edward E. Morann, Chair.	2023
	Robert L. Persing	2023
	Vacant	
	Teresa Thatcher	2023
MLP Manager One Year		
	Lucas Suarez-Orozco	2023
Assistant Manager MLP	Brian Hawthorne-Resigned	2023Moth
Superintendent One Year	Judy A. Williams	2023
Municipal Hearing Officer - M.G.L. Chapter 148A One Year	Vacant	
Plainfield Energy Committee One Year		
	Lyla Rozelle	2023
	Conrad Liebnow	2023
	Renee Schmidt	2023
	Matt Stowell	2023
	Tim Walter	2023

Planning Board Three Year

Peter LaPointe	
(PVPC Comm'r)	2025
Jerry Little	2025
Kevin Greene	2025
Brian Hawthorne, Resigned	2025
Judith Cole, Interim Chair	2025

Police Department One Year

	Justin Litchfield, Chief	2023
<i>Police Chief</i>	Justin Towle-Per Diem	2023
<i>Appoints</i>	Daniel Thibaul-Per Diem	2023
<i>Police Officers</i>	Timothy O'brien	
	Officer Per Diem	2023
	Brandon Iavecchia	
	Officer Per Diem	2023

Recreation Committee Three Year

Sandra Morann, Chair.	2024
Heather Davis	2024
Justina Harrison	2024
Samatha Davis	2024
Roxanne Shearer	2023

Alternates One Year

Vacant

Right to Know Officer One Year

Vacant

Safety Coordinator One Year

Vacant

Surveyors of Wood & Lumber One Year

Claude DuPont III	2023
Vacant	

Tax Collector Two Year

Heather Davis	2024
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Tax Collector Assistant One Year

Amelia Dyer	2023
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Town Clerk Assistant One Year

Theresa Thatcher	2023
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Town Treasurer and Two Year Tax Title Custodian

Amelia Dyer	2023
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Treasurer Assistant One Year

Heather Davis	2023
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Town Administrative Secretary Three Year

Paula King	2025
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Uniform Procurement Officer One Year

Patrick Williamson	2023
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Veteran's Agent One Year

Brian Brooks	2023
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Veterans' Graves Officer One Year

Michael Melle 6/14	2023
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Upper Pioneer Valley Veterans' Service District One Year

Phillip S. Lococo	2023
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Zoning Board of Appeals Three Year

Joan Wattman	2023
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Peg Keller	2023
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Alternate One Year

Ann Irvine	2023
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**APPOINTMENTS DONE IN APRIL-
DONE BY STATE CALENDAR****Inspector of Animals One Year**

Kate Nevins	2023
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APPOINTMENTS DONE IN SEPTEMBER**Cultural Council Three Year**

Corie Locke-Hardy Resigned	2024
Emily Locke-Hardy Resigned	2024
Barbara Westwood	2023
Elaine Sydney	2024
Kathryn Jenson	2024
Ellen Baer	2024

APPOINTMENTS/HIRES NOT DONE BY SELECTMEN**Assessors' Assistant One Year***Assessor's Hire this position*

Gina Papineau	2023
Patricia Morey Assessor's Clk	2023

Finance Committee Three Year*Town Moderator appoints cmte.*

Robert Baker	2023
David Honneus	2024
Vacant	
Terence O'Sullivan	2023
Roberta Wooldridge	2025

Library Director One Year*Library Trustees hire this position*

Denise M. Sessions	2023
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Vocational Ed Advisory Com One Year

Paula King Alt.	2023
Bonnie Phillips	2023

APPOINTMENTS/HIRES DONE BY SELECTMEN**Building Commissioner One Year**

Charlene Bailardi	2023
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Asst. Building Commissioner One Year

Robert Waldeni	6/30/2023
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Highway Superintendent One Year

Walter Jennings	2023
-----------------	------

Tax Collector Deputy One Year

Point Software	2023
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Town Counsel One Year

Atty Ronald Berenson	2023
KP Law	2023

Town Custodian One Year

Bonnie Phillips	2023
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REGISTRARS

The year began with 495 registered voters consisting of 129 Democrats, 36 Republicans, 3 Green Rainbows, 2 United Independent Party and 325 unenrolled

The year ended with 533 registered voters consisting of 131 Democrats, 37 Republicans, 2 Green Rainbows, 2 United Independent Party, 1 Mass Independent Party, 1 Socialist Party, and 359 unenrolled

Respectfully submitted

John Westwood -- Chair

Linda Melle, Robert Fusco, Ruth Osgood

ANNUAL TOWN MEETING MINUTES

The Annual town Meeting was called to order at 1:00 pm on May 7, 2022 by Brian Hawthorne Moderator at the Dennis Thatcher Safety Complex on North Central Street. Approximately 100 people were in attendance. The following actions were taken by the registered voters of Plainfield, MA.

Article 1. To vote by official ballot for all Town Officers, Committees, Trustees, etc., and to fix compensation for the same.

The annual town election took place at the Plainfield Town Hall on Main Street from 1 to 6 p.m. on May 7, 2022

RESULTS OF FY 2023 TOWN ELECTION May 7, 2022

96 Plainfield Registered Voters came out to vote on Saturday May 7, 2022. The results were as follows for 10 uncontested candidates and 2 ballot questions.

POSITION	CANDIDATE	VOTES	BLANKS	WRITE IN
Board Of Assessors	Ronald Weeks	78	18	
Board of Selectman	Ben Gillett	64	26	6
Board of Health	Ellen Dupont	87	9	
1st Constable	Merton Taylor, Sr	93	3	
2nd Constable	Ed Morann	93	3	
Library Trustee	Linda Mason	94	2	
Moderator	Brian Hawthorne	92	4	
School Committee	Amanda Walters	83	13	
Town Clerk	Ruth Osgood	89	7	
Tree Warden	Robert Mellstrom	83	13	

Question 1	YES	70	NO	23	Blank 3
Question 2	YES	56	NO	26	Blank 4

A vote Yes for both Question 1 and 2 means that the principle and interest on those loans are excluded from the proposition 2.5 levy limits.

Article 2. To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or otherwise provide such amounts of money as are reasonable and necessary to defray the expenses of the town for the fiscal year beginning July 1, 2022, or take any other action relative thereto.

Two items in the published budget were changed from the recommended amount:

Police salary budget approved at \$129,090 as requested.

AND Custodian grounds and supplies account was reduced by \$4,992.00 from \$21,541 to \$16,549 per recommendation of the Building Committee

Article 3. To see if the Town will vote to raise and appropriate or transfer from available funds a sum of money to operate the broadband enterprise: Salaries/Stipends \$10,000.00, Expenses: \$319,778.00 Extra/Unforeseen: \$13,000.00, and that the amount of \$342,778.00 be raised as follows: \$342,778.00 from Broadband Departmental Receipts, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Select Board and MLP Manager Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 4. To see if the Town will vote to amend the MOHAWK TRAIL REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT – REGIONAL DISTRICT AGREEMENT by striking the following language contained in Section III (B) – Pupils Entitled to Attend Regional Elementary Schools: The pre-K-12 Member Towns are defined as Ashfield, Buckland, Colrain, Plainfield, Heath, and Shelburne. Subject to the provisions of this section, it is intended that elementary students residing in the member towns of Ashfield, Buckland, Colrain, Plainfield and Shelburne will receive their education in facilities located in the District and will be assigned as follows:

Ashfield and Plainfield residents to Sanderson Academy; Colrain residents to Colrain Central School; and Buckland and Shelburne residents to Buckland Shelburne Elementary School. Elementary students residing in Heath will receive their education in the Hawlemont Regional School District pursuant to a tuition agreement between the Mohawk Trail Regional School District and the Hawlemont Regional School District through no longer than June 30, 2023.

During the period of such tuition agreement, the Town of Heath shall seek in good faith to negotiate with the Hawlemont Regional School District regarding joinder of the Town of Heath into the Hawlemont Regional School District for elementary education. The tuition agreement shall constitute a binding financial obligation of the District. Heath may withdraw from the Mohawk Trail Regional School

District for grades PK-6 in accordance with the “Withdrawal” section of this Agreement. Heath shall remain responsible for its outstanding indebtedness, if any, including but not limited to OPEB, to the Mohawk Trail Regional School District despite such withdrawal in accordance with the terms of the Regional Agreement.

If, upon the expiration of such tuition agreement, as may be extended, Heath and the Hawlemont Regional School District have failed to reach agreement as to the joinder of Heath into the Hawlemont Regional School District, elementary students residing in Heath will receive their education in facilities located in the Mohawk Trail Regional School District, the specific location(s) to be decided as provided herein. The Mohawk Trail Regional School Committee will offer at least two (2) facilities located in the District as options for educating the elementary students of Heath and the Heath members of the Committee will determine which one (1) facility to recommend to the Committee for the placement of all Heath resident elementary students. No facility will be approved by the committee without the affirmative votes of both Heath Committee representatives, provided however that in the event of a tie vote between such Heath representatives, or in the event that there are vacancies in the positions of Heath representatives, a majority vote of the Committee will prevail. The determination must occur no later than November 1st of the school year prior to the change.

and replacing said language with the following:

The pre-K-12 Member Towns are defined as Ashfield, Buckland, Colrain, Plainfield, Heath, and Shelburne. Subject to the provisions of this section, it is intended that elementary students residing in the member towns of Ashfield, Buckland, Colrain,

Heath, Plainfield and Shelburne will receive their education in facilities located in the District and will be assigned as follows: Ashfield and Plainfield residents to Sanderson Academy; Colrain and Heath residents to Colrain Central School; and Buckland and Shelburne residents to Buckland Shelburne

Inserted by the MTRSD

Passed Unanimously

Article 5. To see if the Town will vote to amend the MOHAWK TRAIL REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT – Regional DISTRICT AGREEMENT by striking the following language contained in Section IV (E) – Apportionment of Capital Costs Grades pre-K-6:

(3) The Heath Elementary School Building shall be returned to the Town of Heath on July 1, 2017, and the Lease between the parties shall terminate as of said date. In exchange for termination of the lease, the District shall pay to the Town of Heath a total sum of \$240,000.00, such payment to be made in no fewer than three (3) annual installments. The amounts and timing of such installments shall be agreed upon in writing by the School Committee and the Town of Heath, provided however that the final installment shall be due no later than June 30, 2020. Any outstanding debt payments associated with the Heath Elementary School shall remain the responsibility of the Town of Heath, and the Town of Heath shall continue to be assessed for said debt in accordance with the terms of this Agreement.

(4) Capital costs representing payments of principal and interest on bonds, notes or other obligations as issued by the Committee to finance expenses in the nature of capital outlay for the purpose of construction at the site of, or reconstruction to, the Colrain Central School or upon any premises as may be leased to the Mohawk Trail Regional School District by the Town of Colrain, shall be borne by the Town of Colrain.

5) Nothing in this section shall be construed to prevent the member towns from amending any this Agreement and modifying and/or altering the above designated schedules of apportionment of capital costs in the event subsequent school construction or reconstruction results in a change of grade level or town assignments to the District schools.

And replacing said language with the following:

(3) Colrain, Heath

Effective commencing with Fiscal Year 2023, new capital costs incurred by the committee and associated with grades pre-kindergarten to six, inclusive, of the District school or schools serving the pupils from the Towns of Colrain and Heath shall be apportioned to the Towns of Colrain and Heath as follows:

To Colrain: A portion of the total of all principal and interest on bonds, notes or other obligations as issued by the Committee consistent with the above, expressed as a percentage of the total to the nearest one-hundredth of one percent calculated as follows: By (1), computing the ratio which the sum of enrollments of pupils at the Colrain Center School, resident in the Town of Col-

rain as determined by the census of pupils at said district school each October 1 for the five most recent years, bears to the sum of enrollments of pupils at said district school, resident in the Towns of Heath and Colrain as determined by the census of pupils each October 1 for the five most recent years (note: pre-K enrollment will be included in the calculation); and by (2) expressing such ratio as a percentage. Until five years data becomes available, the most recent years of data shall be used to determine said ratio.

To Heath: A portion of the total of all principal and interest on bonds, notes or other obligations as issued by the Committee on or after July 1, 2022 consistent hundredth of one percent calculated as follows: By (1), computing ratio which the sum of the enrollments of pupils at the Colrain Central School, resident in the Town of Heath, as determined by the census of pupils at said district school each October 1 for the five most recent years, bears to the sum of enrollments of pupils at the said district school, resident in the Towns of Colrain and Heath, as determined by the census of pupils each October 1 for the five most recent years (note: pre-K enrollment will be included in the calculation); and by (2) expressing such ratio as a percentage. Until five years of data becomes available, the most recent years of data shall be used to determine said ratio.

(4) The Heath Elementary School Building was returned to the Town of Heath on July 1, 2017, and the Lease between the parties terminated as of said date. In exchange for termination of the lease, the District paid to the Town of Heath a total sum of \$240,000.00. Any outstanding debt payments associated with the Heath Elementary School shall remain the responsibility of the Town of Heath, and the Town of Heath shall continue to be assessed for said debt in accordance with the terms of this Agreement.

(5) Capital costs representing payments of principal and interest on bonds, notes or other obligations as issued by the Committee to finance expenses in the nature of capital outlay for the purpose of construction at the site of, or reconstruction to, the Colrain Central School or upon any premises as may be leased to the Mohawk Trail Regional School District by the Town of Colrain, shall be borne by the Towns of Colrain and Heath, as provided in Section E. (3), above

(6) Noting inn this section shall be construed to prevent the member towns from amending this Agreement and modifying and/or altering the above designated schedules of apportionment of capital costs in the event subsequent school construction or apportionment results in a change of grade level or town assignments to the District schools.

Inserted by the MTRSD

Passed Unanimously

Article 6. To see if the town will vote to amend the MOHAWK TRAIL REGIONAL SCHOOL DISTRICT – REGIONAL DISTRICT AGREEMENT by striking the following language contained in Section XV Effective Date:

This amended Agreement shall take full effect in accordance with its terms on July 1, 2018 and shall supersede the prior District Agreement, including any prior amendments.

And replacing said language with the following:

This amended Agreement shall take full effect in accordance with its terms on July 1, 2022 and shall supersede the prior District Agreement, including any prior amendments.

Inserted by the MTRSD

Passed Unanimously

Article 7. To see if the town will vote to allow the Mohawk Trail Regional School District to borrow a sum of money, not to exceed \$278,400, for work at the Colrain Central School in Colrain, Massachusetts, to include rebuilding or resurfacing of parking lots and certain walkways, and brick masonry repairs and repointing, and including costs incidental thereto, which purpose of the projects will materially extend the useful life of the school and preserve the asset capable of supporting the required educational program. Said sum is to be expended under the approval of the School Committee's Building Subcommittee, and to meet said appropriation, the District Treasurer, with the approval of the Chair, is authorized to borrow said sum under MGL Ch. 44 or any other enabling authority, or take any action relative thereto.

Submitted by the School Committee article was
postponed indefinitely

Article 8. To see if the Town will vote to establish a Fire Truck Stabilization Fund under the provisions of M.G. L. Chapter 40, Sec. 5B for the purpose of funding the purchase of a fire truck, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Fire Department Supported by the Finance Committee Requires a 2/3 vote

Passed Unanimously

Article 9. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$50,000.00 from Free Cash to the Fire Truck Stabilization Fund, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Fire Department Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 10. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$13,700.00 from the Free Cash for the purchase of a lawnmower to take effect in FY22, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Buildings Committee Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 11. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$10,000.00 from Free Cash to the FY22 Buildings Operation Account, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Town Accountant

Passed Unanimously

Article 12. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$26,000.00 from Free Cash to replace the Town Hall heating system to take effect in FY23, or any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Buildings Committee

Supported by the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 13. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$2,400.00 from Free Cash for the purchase of bullet proof vests for the police department to take effect in FY23, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Police Department

Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 14. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$1,000.00 from Free Cash for the purchase of a hand-held radar to take effect in FY23, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Police Department

Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Majority Yes with one (1) opposed

Article 15. To see if the Town will vote to rescind the unused Broadband debt authorization in the amount of \$130,000.00, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the MLP Manager and the Town Accountant

Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 16. To see if the Town will vote to pay an FY21 Whip City Fiber invoice in the amount of \$1,522.56 from the FY22 Broadband Expense Account, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the MLP Manager & the Town Accountant

Supported by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 17. To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to borrow up to \$75,000.00 for up to five years for a new pick-up truck approximately GVW 10,000 lbs. capable of plowing, towing, and any other task necessary for the Highway Department, or take any action relative thereto.

Submitted by the Highway Department

Supported by the Finance Committee Requires a 2/3 vote

Passed Unanimously

Article 18. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$107,386.86 from the Broadband retained Earnings Account to the Broadband Stabilization Fund, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Town Accountant and MLP Manager

Passed Unanimously

Article 19. To see if the Town will authorize the Assessors to apply \$80,000.00 from Free Cash to reduce the Fiscal 2023 tax rate, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Town Accountant

Recommended by the Finance Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 20. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$46,657.00 from Free Cash to the Stabilization Fund, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Town Accountant Recommended by the Finance Committee and the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 21. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$351.50 from Library Sales and Fines to the Library, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Town Accountant

Passed Unanimously

Article 22. To see if the Town will vote to establish a Broadband Board under the authority of Massachusetts General Laws Chapter 41 Section 1 and with the powers of a Municipal Light Board under Chapter 164, to amend the Bylaws for the Town of Plainfield by adding the following bylaw, and to instruct the Town Clerk to assign a number to this bylaw and to renumber this and other bylaw articles as may be necessary, or take any action relative thereto. (see handout for complete text)

Inserted by the MLP Manager Requires a 2/3 vote

Passed unanimously to postpone indefinitely

Article 23. To see if the Town will vote to amend the Bylaws for the Town of Plainfield by adding the Plainfield Wetlands Protection Bylaw (see handout for complete text), or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Conservation Commission Requires a 2/3 vote

Article failed to pass by a 2/3 vote. 45 Yes and 40 No

Article 24. To see if the Town will authorize the Select Board to apply, accept, and expend for specific purposes provided by any Federal or State Grants or Programs which may be awarded to the Town.

Inserted by the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 25. To see if the Town will vote to accept as available funds any and all monies from the Executive Office of Transportation for Fiscal 2023.

Inserted by the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 26. To see if the Town will choose or create, as appropriate, any other

Town Committees, Boards, Commissions, Trustees, Offices, etc., and to fix compensation for the same, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Select Board

Voted to take no action

Article 27. To see if the Town will vote to authorize the Select Board to retain legal counsel for the town, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 28. To see if the Town will vote to leave the care, maintenance and repair of the Town Hall, Shaw Memorial Library, Hallock Memorial School Building, Hathaway Hall, Police Department Building, Firehouse, Town Garage, Police Station, Public Safety Building, and surrounding areas, in the charge of the Buildings Committee, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Buildings Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 29. To see if the Town will vote to leave the care, operation, maintenance, and repair of the Broadband municipal light plant telecommunications system, including buildings or other structures and the land surrounding them and any extensions or expansions of said system or plant, in the charge of the Select Board, in accordance with the provisions of Chapter 164 of the Massachusetts General Laws, or take any action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Select Board and the MLP Manager

Passed Unanimously

Article 30. To see if the Town will vote to leave the care, maintenance and repair of the cemeteries in the charge of the Cemetery Committee, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Cemetery Committee

Passed Unanimously

Article 31. To see if the Town will vote to leave the care, maintenance and repair of the highways, public ways, including the alteration and widening thereof, railings and bridges in the charge of the Select Board, or take any other action relative thereto.

Inserted by the Select Board

Passed Unanimously

Article 32. To see if the Town will vote to accept the reports of the Town Officers, Boards, Committees, Trustees, etc. as printed in the Town Report.

Passed Unanimously

Article 33. To see if the Town will vote to transact any other business that may legally come before this meeting.

Passed unanimously no other business brought before the meeting. Town Meeting was adjourned at 3:30 pm by the moderator.

A true record to the best of my knowledge.

ATTEST: Ruth E. Osgood, Town Clerk

A True Copy:

ATTEST: Ruth Osgood, Town Clerk

SPECIAL TOWN MEETING MINUTES

Special Town Meeting was called to order by the Town Clerk at 7 p.m. in Plainfield Town Hall. 40 people were in attendance. Brian Hawthorne, Moderator could not be present. A temporary moderator was called. Patrick Williamson and Ed Morann were nominated. A vote was taken and Ed Morann was elected and sworn in for this one meeting. The following actions were taken on the articles brought before the Special Town Meeting.

TOWN OF PLAINFIELD SPECIAL TOWN MEETING WARRANT Hampshire, ss:

To either of the Constables of the Town of Plainfield,
GREETINGS:

In the name of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, you are hereby directed to notify and warn the inhabitants of the Town of Plainfield qualified to vote in town affairs, to assemble at the Town Hall, Tuesday, October 11, 2022 at 7:00 p.m. then and there to act on the following articles, to wit

Article 1. Article 1. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$19,114.52 from the Stabilization Fund to pay Fiscal 2022 Morton Salt invoices, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Accountant and the Highway Superintendent Recommended by the Finance Committee Requires 9/10 vote
38 Yes 0 Opposed

Article 2. To see if the Town will vote to pay the amount of \$463.50 from the Fiscal 2023 Police Department Expense Account to pay Fiscal 2022 AT&T FirstNet for May and June invoices, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Town Accountant Recommended by the Finance Committee Requires a 9/10 vote
38 Yes 0 Opposed

Article 3. To see if the Town will vote to transfer the amount of \$17,500.00 from the Stabilization Fund to upgrade the Town's telephone system, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Select Board. Recommended by the Finance Committee Requires a 2/3 vote
36 Yes 0 Opposed

Article 4. To see if the Town will transfer the of \$5,000.00 from the Stabilization Fund to the Fiscal 2023 Town Counsel Account, or take any action relative thereto. Inserted by the Select Board Recommended by the Finance Committee Requires a 2/3 vote
35 Yes 0 Opposed

The Special Town Meeting was adjourned at 7:36 pm
A true record to the best of my knowledge:
ATTEST: Ruth E. Osgood, Town Clerk A True Copy:
ATTEST: Ruth E. Osgood, Town Clerk



MERT, JR. RETIRES.

This morning was Mert Taylor Jr's final day as an employee of the Town of Plainfield.

He retires from both the Highway and Fire/EMS departments after 35 years of paid and volunteer service in multiple positions for the town. We hosted a small gathering of co-workers and town employees in a surprise gathering to recognize his contributions to the town.

He had no idea of the gathering and was very appreciative of the support he's been given.

Thank you Mert.

SELECTBOARD

The passing of another year is upon us and I want to take the time to thank all who are involved in the efforts it takes to keep our small rural town running. Thank you for being so dedicated and generous with your time to ensure that our community can accomplish the various tasks that we encounter each year. We have said goodbye to some long-time board members and have welcomed some new faces to the group. To all of you, great job and thank you.

In the wake of the Covid-19 pandemic, the state put into place the American Rescue Plan Act of 2021. This is providing local entities, among others, with federal funds to use in response to certain impacts the pandemic has had on our community. The town of Plainfield received a total of \$197,500 of which we delegated \$104,100 to Plainfield Broadband for connecting new customers, upgrading the broadband HUB alarm, and to build a MESH network with other towns to reduce costs. The highway department was given the go ahead to use \$36,300 to buy two electronic message boards to help communicate important town service announcements at the roadside. The One Plainfield group formed in August and has collected submitted ideas from the towns people on how we might use the remaining funds. They will conduct a process of elimination to determine if the suggested uses will fit into the federal guidelines for use of the funds. Once this is complete they will submit a recommendation to the Select board and we will determine how to distribute the balance.

We welcomed two new people to the Plainfield team this past

year. Our previous building commissioner submitted a letter of resignation in March 2022. We appointed Charlene Baiardi as an interim building commissioner on March 22, 2022. The position was then posted, we conducted interviews with the applicants on June 8th, and the position was awarded to Charlene Baiardi. We also welcomed Ben Gillett as the newest member to the Select board on July 1, 2022.

The Plainfield Police Working Group implemented a community survey on policing in February 2022. This survey served as an opportunity for the Plainfield Police and the Select board to receive input from the members of the community on the current workings of our police department for the purposes of giving the community a voice and helping the board more effectively fulfill the role of supervisor to the police. The data collection and analysis of this survey were posted in March 2022 which resulted from the participation of 33% of the eligible members of the community (Plainfield adults age 18 or older). The survey was largely a success and the resulting document is an asset to both the Select board and the Plainfield Police.

Since the board adoption of a standard template for all future Host Community Agreements with wholesale marijuana establishments in 2021 there has been some major changes in the guidelines originally set by the state on such matters. We received notice from KP Law that read:

“On August 11, 2022, Governor Baker signed Chapter 180 of the Acts of 2022, “An Act Relative to Equity in the Cannabis Industry”. The Act substantially revises G.L. c. 94G, § 3 and changes the role of the Massachusetts Cannabis Control Commission (the “CCC”) with regard to host community agreements (“HCAs”), giving the CCC regulatory oversight for and approval of HCAs, limiting municipalities’ ability to collect community impact fees for anticipated costs not yet appropriated, establishing considerable penalties for municipalities that fail to or improperly document impact costs, and prohibiting certain monetary commitments beyond community impact fees. The Act also establishes a mechanism by which communities may waive the HCA requirement entirely.”

This will require adjustments in the future for any new establishments for consideration and renewing of current HCA’s. As with any new endeavor, our participation in this industry is a work in progress.

Almost a decade ago, Plainfield joined with Ashfield, Chesterfield, Cummington, Goshen, and Williamsburg joined together to form the Highland Ambulance Service as a non-profit cooperative enterprise to provide emergency medical and ambulance services to hill town residents. As part of that enterprise, each town paid an assessment in proportion to their population, and Highland Ambulance has been in successful operation ever since. This last year, however, the State of Massachusetts imposed a substantial additional cost on operation of the service. In an attempt to help public ambulance services, it imposed a fee/assessment/tax on private ambulance services with the intention of distributing the resulting revenue to public services. In drafting the legislation, they exempted cooperative services set up by towns in municipal districts; by mistake, they failed to recognize similar cooperatives (like Highland Ambulance) set by towns that are not part of single municipal districts (essentially rural areas). Ours was one of about half a dozen such services in the State, and special legislation is required to remedy this injustice; efforts to pass such legislation are underway. The impact of this mistake was amplified by another blunder; the size of the assessments were set on the basis of the income from services provided, but the assessment for Highland Ambulance was inflated by also counting as income the money that the towns contribute to make the service possible. This misstep over doubled the size of the assessment for our little cooperative, but subsequent protests remedied this problem. Nevertheless, this additional expense remained, but was largely offset by the good fortune of the completion of some debt obligations in this last year. The result was an assessment for Plainfield that was close to the amount for that line item last year.

We encourage you to get involved in the largely volunteer work of your community. We do the majority of our work at the Select Board meetings which are always available to the public. These meetings are held on the 2nd and 4th Tuesday of the month at 7pm, in person at the Town Hall. If you are interested in what is currently being worked on or have any questions or concerns, we invite you to join us.

Respectfully submitted,
Hilary Weeks



G. Fusco

ALL DEPARTMENTS EXPENDITURE REPORT

From 07/01/2021 to 06/30/2022

Description	Carry Fwd	Orig Bud	Amended	Encumb	Expend	Unencomb Bal	%Exp
Board of Selectmen		5,000.00			3,500.00	1,500.00	70.00 %
Town Office Expense		12,500.00			11,748.81	751.19	93.99 %
Treasurer		14,641.00			14,265.56	374.44	97.43 %
Administrative Secretary		22,677.00			22,677.00		100.00 %
Moderator		100.00			100.00		100.00 %
Accountant		15,576.00			15,576.00		100.00 %
Tax Title Expense		7,000.00				7,000.00	0.00 %
Training/Seminar Expense		500.00			500.00		0.00 %
Town Counsel		4,000.00			2,695.52	1,304.48	67.38 %
Assistant Town Clerk Salary		568.00			568.00		100.00 %
Assessors		11,090.00			9,132.60	1,957.40	82.34 %
Assessors Salaries		29,670.00			26,702.78	2,967.22	89.99 %
Town Office Technology		4,000.00				4,000.00	0.00 %
Website Expense		500.00			480.00	20.00	96.00 %
IT Service/Expense		9,000.00			3,486.25	5,513.75	38.73 %
Tax Collector		11,100.00			8,697.73	2,402.27	78.35 %
Collectors Salaries		12,866.00			12,865.92	0.08	99.99 %
Town Clerk		5,000.00			947.97	4,052.03	18.95 %
Town Clerk Salary		13,041.00			13,041.00		100.00 %
Conservation Commission		730.00			258.40	471.60	35.39 %
Finance Committee		150.00			135.00	15.00	90.00 %
Planning Board		7,000.00			1,035.29	5,964.71	14.78 %
Franklin Reg. Council of Govt.		2,500.00			510.00	1,999.00	20.40 %
Highway Salaries		208,679.00	17,900.00		226,573.95	5.05	99.99 %
Highway General		65,000.00	-43,419.00		21,581.00		100.00 %
Machinery Upkeep		70,000.00	10,238.00		79,985.13	252.87	99.68 %
Winter Roads		95,000.00	16,781.00		111,780.23	0.77	99.99 %
Street Lights		775.00			674.14	100.86	86.98 %
Mohawk Reg. School Operat		906,208.00			906,054.25	153.75	98.98 %
Mohawk Regional School		18,550.00			15,303.75	3,246.25	82.50 %
Vocational Tuition		180,000.00			145,664.96	34,335.04	80.92 %
School Committee Expense		750.00				750.00	0.00 %
Shaw Memorial Library		22,778.00			22,778.00		100.00 %
Upper Pioneer Valley Vet. Dist.		1,737.00			1,736.18	0.82	99.95 %
Cemetery Commission		4,000.00			2,048.00	1,952.00	51.20 %
Memorial Day/Veterans' Flags		300.00			252.88	47.12	84.29 %
Enterprise Broadband Salary		6,000.00			6,000.00		100.00 %
Enterprise Broadband Expense		270,657.00			220,357.40	50,299.60	81.41 %
Enterprise Broadband Extra/Unforsee		20,459.00				20,459.00	0.00 %
Police Department	490.83	34,531.00			34,923.62	98.21	99.71 %
Police Salaries		107,892.00			103,886.89	4,005.11	96.28 %
Fire Department		32,186.00	174.60		32,360.60		100.00 %
Highland Ambulance EMS		32,593.00			32,592.16	0.84	99.99 %
Blackboard Connect		2,000.00			1,602.71	397.29	80.13 %
Fire Chief Salary		7,500.00			7,500.00		100.00 %
Fire Chief Admin. Assist.		3,000.00	200.00		3,200.00		100.00 %
Building Alarms		1,500.00			1,440.00	60.00	96.00 %
Building Inspector		9,800.00			8,320.00	1,480.00	84.89 %
Plumbing Inspector		1,800.00			1,800.00		100.00 %
Electrical Inspector		2,670.00			2,400.00	270.00	89.88 %
Emergency Management/CD		1,000.00			589.86	410.14	58.98 %
Animal Control Officer		2,000.00			2,000.00		100.00 %
Animal Control Off. Exp.		1,150.00			102.40	139.60.00	6.82 %

Description	Carry Fwd	Orig Bud	Amended	Encumb	Expend	Unencomb Bal	%Exp
Barn & Cattle Inspector		800.00			800.00		100.00 %
Immunizations		500.00			500.00		0.00 %
Tree Warden		12,000.00			11,993.00	7.00	99.94 %
Compactor		31,700.00			22,829.90	8,770.10	72.01 %
Compactor Salary	29.86	11,060.00			8,054.96	3,034.90	72.63 %
Hilltown Res. Mgmnt Coop		3,022.00			3,022.00		100.00 %
Compactor Building		5,000.00			5,000.00		100.00%
Public Safety Bldg. Bond Prin.		9,537.00			9,537.00		100.00 %
Hwy Dump Truck w/ Wing Loan		23,102.00			23,102.00		100.00 %
2019 Western Star		23,798.00			23,797.60	0.40	99.99 %
Broadband Principal		65,000.00			64,743.41	256.59	99.60%
Int. Long-term Debt		32,663.00			23,096.86	9,566.86	70.71 %
Int. Short-term Debt		1,000.00	152.14		1,152.14		100.00 %
Insurance		60,500.00			58,240.22	2,259.78	96.26 %
Town Building Repair		18,000.00			14,830.27	3,169.73	83.39 %
ADA		100.00				100.00	0.00 %
Twn. Bldg. Operations		54,000.00	10,000.00		61,032.27	2,967.73	95.36%
Twn. Bldg. Sup/Maint/Cust		21,219.00			16,166.79	5,052.21	76.19%
Lawnmower			13,700.00		13,607.10	92.92	99.32 %
Highway Garage Roof	59,000.00				920.87	58,079.13	1.56 %
Hathaway Hall Int.Renovations	24,600.00					24,600.00	0.00 %
Town Hall Painting		25,000.00				25,000.00	0.00 %
Town Hall Fire Escape	24,600.00					24,600.00	0.00 %
Town Reports		1,300.00		843.00	457.00		64.84 %
Council on Aging	30.00	6,500.00			4,130.35	2,399.65	63.25 %
Recreation Committee		1,200.00			1,200.00		100.00 %
Flags/Flowers		350.00			108.86	241.14	31.10 %
Historical Commission		500.00			468.20	31.80	93.64 %
Agricultural Commission		200.00			31.73	168.27	15.86 %
County Retirement		79,858.00			79,858.00		100.00 %
Medicare		9,000.00			8,280.56	719.44	92.00 %
Unemployment		1,500.00			561.90	938.10	37.46 %
Chapter 32B Medical Ins.		67,400.00			48,485.39	18,914.61	71.93 %
Reserve Fund		4,000.00	-2,026.74			1,973.26	0.00 %
Total	108,750.69	2,869,883.00			2,648,325.60	354,325.60	
Total GENERAL FUND	108,750.69	2,869,883.00			2,648,325.60	354,325.60	

ZONING BOARD OF APPEALS

The Zoning Board had no applications come before it in 2022. However, it did hold two sessions to provide comments requested by the Planning Board on special permit applications being heard by that board. Comments were submitted relative to the battery storage unit proposed for the Nexamp Solar Array installation on North Union Street and for the proposed marijuana growing and cultivation operation on Grant Street.

Respectfully submitted,

Peg Keller, Chair, Joan Wattman, Ann Irvine

TOWN VITALS

During 2022 there were 6 recorded deaths in Plainfield, 4 recorded births and 2 marriages. Plainfield's population is approximately 633 and approximately 530 voters.

Respectfully submitted,

Ruth Osgood, Town Clerk

TOWN ACCOUNTANT BALANCE SHEET

From 07/01/2021 TO 06/30/2022

ASSETS

CASH	Assets	Liabilities
General Cash	654,939.98	
TOTAL FOR CASH		654,939.98
PERSONAL PROPERTY TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Personal Prop Taxes F2012	377.22	
Personal Prop Taxes F2014	83.19	
Personal Prop Taxes F2019	821.83	
TOTAL PERSONAL PROP TAXES		1,282.24
REAL ESTATE TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Real Estate Taxes F2010	34.49	
Real Estate Taxes F2012	5,331.68	
Real Estate Taxes F2013	525.58	
Real Estate Taxes F2014	908.86	
Real Estate Taxes F2015	900.69	
Real Estate Taxes F2018	520.61	
Real Estate Taxes F2019	4,725.31	
Real Estate Taxes F2020	80,079.65	
TOTAL FOR REAL ESTATE TAXES		92,971.54
MOTOR VEHICLE EX TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Motor Vehicle Ex F2009	384.70	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2010	672.43	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2011	1,298.36	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2012	872.03	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2013	1,379.51	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2014	429.06	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2016	206.23	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2017	623.91	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2018	3,800.67	
Motor Vehicle Ex F2019	13,357.20	
TOTAL MOTOR VEHICLE EX TAXES	24,318.20	
FARM EXCISE TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Farm Animal Excise	4,352.30	
TOTAL FOR FARM EXCISE TAXES		4,352.30
TAX TITLES & POSSESSIONS	Assets	Liabilities
Tax Titles	138,058.22	
TOTAL TAX TITLES & POSSESSIONS		138,058.22
ACCOUNTS RECEIVABLE	Assets	Liabilities
Highway Chapter 291B	70,716.56	
TOTAL ACCOUNTS RECEIVABLE		70,716.56
LOANS AUTHORIZED	Assets	Liabilities
Loans Authorized	130,000.00	
Due frm Whiting Strt Fund	1,280.00	
TOTAL LOANS AUTHORIZED		131,280.00
TEMPORARY LOANS	Assets	Liabilities
Temporary Loan-Revenue	1,400,000.00	
TOTAL TEMPORARY LOANS		1,400,000.00

AGENCY	Assets	Liabilities
Federal Withholding	1,893.37	
ING	812,70	
Medicare Withholding	221.12	
State Withholding	704.44	
County Retirement	314.23	
TOTAL FOR AGENCY		3,945.86.00

GRANTS Assets Liabilities		
MVP Action Grant	1,000.00	
Broadband Construction	8,257.10	
TOTAL FOR GRANTS		9,527.10.

TOTAL ASSETS	2,531,392.00
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LIABILITIES

PERSONAL PROPERTY TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Personal Prop Taxes 20		153.26
TOTAL PERSONAL PROPERTY TAXES		146.94

MOTOR VEHICLE EX TAXES	Assets	Liabilities
Motor Vehicle Ex F2015		146.94
TOTAL FOR MOTOR VEHICLE EX TAXES		146.94

REVENUE	Assets	Liabilities
Revenue Fiscal 2020		201,237.62
TOTAL FOR REVENUE		201,237.62

AGENCY	Assets	Liabilities
Dental Insurance With.		59.21
License to Carry/State		656.25
NEXAMP Decommission Escrow		27,703.00
BC/BS - Officials		1,260.04
Unclaimed checks		187.93
TOTAL FOR AGENCY		30,555.88

GRANTS	Assets	Liabilities
Library Grant		27,533.45
Library-Mass Humanities Grant		1,802.05
Cultural Council		5,486.75
Dog Kennel Gift		12.65
Emergency Management/FEMA		2,297.00
Homeland Security Grant		167.74
COVID-19 Emergency CARES		606.01
Septic System Rpr. Grant		68,008.56
Community Policing Grant		290.31
Green Commun. Designation Grant		11,894.26
Community Compact Wage Salary Grant		4,000.00
DPH COVIT-19		1,166.74
IT Grant		41,370.00
Health Bd Emer Prep Grant		1,469.30

BoH RDP Grant	15,474.08
Direct Energy Solar Gift	3,011.22
SAMSHA Grant	1,000.00
Med-Project Grant	1,300.00
Police Dept. Donations	525.94
Council on Aging Gifts	3,217.59
Fire Dept. Truck Donation	363.01
Library Gifts	4,621.44
Cemetery Gifts	300.00
Cemetery (Funds Approp. for Use)	17.87
Recreation/General	4,315.64
Baseball Activities Donations	1,000.00
Playstructure @ Ballfield	2,478.85
Flag Gifts	505.84
WiredWest Donations	4.76
Library Addition	1,497.63
Historical Comm Donation	11.74
TOTAL FOR GRANTS	205,750.43

REVOLVING	Assets	Liabilities
Deputy Tax Collector Fees		843.00
Off-Duty Police Detail		189.00
Ch 148A Municipal Enforcement Fines		200.00
Loans Authorized Unissued		130,000.00
Temporary Loan		1,400,000.00
TOTAL FOR REVOLVING		1,531,232.00

RCPTS RESVRD FOR APPROP	Assets	Liabilities
Cemetery Lot Int./Perpet. Care		1,690.39
Conservation Comm/Wetland		3,337.55
TNC Revenues		0.20
Library Sales & Fines		91.50
TOTAL RCPTS RESVRD FOR APPROP		5,119.64

OVERLAYS RES FOR ABATE	Assets	Liabilities
Overlay F2017		94,571.50
TOTAL FOR OVERLAYS RES FOR ABATE		94,571.50

REVENUE RESERVED UNTIL COL	Assets	Liabilities
Tax Title & Poss. Rev.		138,058.22
Motor Vehicle Excise Rev		24,318.20
Special Tax Revenue		4,352.30
Hwy Chapter 291B Revenue		70,716.56
Cemetery Lot Revenue		16,023.19
CDBG Housing Rehab Repayment		17,339.32
TOTAL REV. RESERVED UNTIL COL		270,807.79

SURPLUS REVENUE	Assets	Liabilities
Surplus Revenue		191,816.94
TOTAL FOR SURPLUS REVENUE		191,816.94

TOTAL LIABILITIES	2,531,392.00
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TRUST FUNDS	Assets	Liabilities
Trust Cash		605,339.95
Due To General Fund		1,280.00
Cemetery PC Fund		2,783.01
Arts Lottery Fund		977.11
M. Arvilla Dyer Lib. Fnd		2,868.69
Martha Smith Library Fund		3,934.24
Whiting Street Fund		2,380.69
Stabilization		591,059.39
TOTAL TRUST FUNDS	605,339.95	605,339.95

LONG TERM DEBT	Assets	Liabilities
Inside Debt Limit	408,409.40	
2019 Western Star		46,204.00
Hwy Dump Truck		69,306.00
Public Safety Building Loan		267,015.00
TOTAL LONG TERM DEBT	408,409.40	408,409.40

ENTERPRISE		
Broadband Enterprise Cash	17,542.26	
Broadband Enterp.Retained Earning		17,542.26
TOTAL ENTERPRISE	17,542.26	17,542.26



Jeanne Sargent

Whitney Sheppard at the Halloween Bonfire

BOARD OF ASSESSORS FOR FISCAL YEAR 2022

Tax Rate Recapitulation for Fiscal Year 2021

Total amount to be raised	\$ 2,954,063.34
Total estimated receipts and revenues from other sources:	703,726.00
Net amount to be raised by taxation (Tax Levy):	2,250,337.34

Valuation by Class

Residential	77,660,483.00
Commercial	8,010,702.00
Industrial	1,503,200.00
Personal Property	25,624,479.00

Total Property

112,798,864.00

Valuation Levy by Class

Residential	1,549,325.75
Commercial	159,814.46
Industrial	29,988.00
Personal Property	511,209.13

Total Tax Levy

2,250,337.34

Tax Rate

20.72

Number of real estate transfers received in calendar year 2020

Number of motor vehicle excise bills sent:

For registration year 2021	13	189,27.00
For registration year 2022	923	80,117.69

Number of motor vehicle abatements granted:

For registration year 2019	16	1,848.67
For registration year 2020	10	399.62
For registration year 2021	13	532.22

Exemptions for real estate granted:

5 2,675.00

Abatements for real estate granted:

4 ,401.50

Parcel Count

Tax Exempt Property Value: Town, State, Charities, Audubon
Exempted Tax Dollars

79 11,135,400.00
214,245.10

Respectfully Submitted,
Claude DuPont III, Chairman, Ronald Weeks, Daniel Lachance



Jack Nelson

TREASURER'S REPORT**fiscal year ended June 30, 2022****CASH BALANCES** Balances as of June 30, 2022

Easthampton Savings Bank	Vendor & Payroll	\$ 89,734.99
Easthampton Savings Bank	Investment & State Receipts	308,317.75
Easthampton Savings Bank	MLP Broadband	463,101.40
Easthampton Savings Bank	MLP Broadband	157,566.18
Peoples United Bank	Trust – Septic Loan Fund	67,112.85
Adams Community Bank	Trust - Various	13,477.97
Greenfield Savings Bank	Trust – Cemetery Funds	12,060.90
Mass Municipal Deposit Trust	Stabilization	551,937.28
Total Cash Balances June 30, 2022 \$		17,759,084

SHORT TERM DEBT

	Public Safety Complex	\$247,941.00
Outstanding as of June 30, 2022	2019 Western Star	47,595.20
	2017 Dump Truck	0
	Totals	\$ 295,536.20

LONG TERM DEBT

	Broadband	\$380,000
Outstanding as of June 30, 2022	Broadband	\$855,000
	Totals	\$1,235,000.00

TAX TITLE

The Town holds real estate parcels for nonpayment of real property taxes, subject to a right of redemption under the Commonwealth's Tax Taking Statute Ch 60, S 54.

The amount shown below was certified by the Town Collector and includes the outstanding taxes, tax collector's interest and fees.

The amounts are as of June 30, 2022 are: **\$44,840.23**

Respectfully submitted,
Amelia Dwyer, Treasurer

TAX COLLECTOR

	Real estate Balances As of June 30, 2022	Personal Property Balances As of June 30, 2022	Motor Vehicle Balances As of June 30, 2022	Other Excise Balances As of June 30, 2022
2022	83,828.14	14,278.49	11,979.27	2,815.80
2021	51,074.45	78.86	5,352.32	
2020	39,815.13	-153.26	1,478.37	
2019	2,545.06	0	658.54	
Prior Years	2,788.84	460.42	5,478.37	0.00
Totals	129,572.69	14,664.50	25,122.61	2,815.80

Grand Total 222,652.53

All payments are due on the quarterly system, with due dates as follows:

First quarter-August 1, Second Quarter-November 1, Third Quarter-February 1, Fourth Quarter-May 1.

To keep postage to a minimum, I send out First Quarter and Second Quarters together and the Third and Fourth are mailed separately.

Respectfully submitted,
Heather Davis, Tax Collector

VOLUNTEER FIRE/EMS DEPARTMENT



*New Hydrant
at Plainfield Pond*

2022 Hilltown RIT class recruits- including PVFD's Capt. R. Shearer, LT. J. Wooldridge and FF D. Shearer.

The past year was one of the busiest years ever for the Plainfield Volunteer Fire/EMS Department (PVFD). According to Northampton Control, our department's dispatching center in Northampton, we were called out 157 times in 2022. The calls included MVA's (motor vehicle accidents), chimney fires, fire alarm sounding, illegal outside fires, fire permit inspections, traffic and safety hazards, live wires down, fire investigations (smell of smoke or order), assist other town agencies, hazardous materials incident, mutual aid fires, brush fires, structure fire and 57 medical/trauma emergencies. These emergencies happen 24/7-365 days each year many times, in the middle of the night or midday. There is no rhyme or reason. The PVFD First Responders and EMT's must be ready to deal with a host of potential emergencies. Most of our roster work regular jobs that take them out of town day and sometimes nights. The challenge of staffing all emergency calls is never ending for our small rural fire department.

This year, we lost a veteran FF/EMT. Brian Hawthorne has retired after giving years of time to responding to your emergencies. Thank you, Brian! However, we gained a new firefighter, as Finn McMillan has returned home after school, after becoming an EMT and completing the State Fire Academy Firefighter 1 & 2 rigorous training course certification. Finn was a junior firefighter growing up in town before leaving for college. He now works for Brattleboro, VT. FD, a full-time paid department, but while in town he responds to calls we might have. We are very fortunate to have someone his age and with his training in our department. Our roster remains at 19 overall, unusual for a town of our size.

The past year began with the department purchasing a new radio system allowing us to remain in full contact with our mutual aid departments in Franklin County. All Franklin County emergency services switched to a brand new 800 MHz communication system via a large grant. Our radio system in Hampshire County no longer works in Franklin County. The Plainfield Volunteer Firefighter's Association (PVFA) annual fund drive allowed us to purchase 7 new Kenwood portable and mobile radios which were installed in our front-line apparatus last summer. The total cost of these new radios was over \$21K. Thank you if you supported this critical fund drive.

We continue to seek state grants to help fund the needs of our fire department. This Fall we completed the long overdue installation of a Dry Fire Hydrant at Plainfield Pond. This was made possible through a 2021 VFA (Volunteer Fire Assistance Grant), the Plainfield Conservation Committee, and Weeks Excavation who acquired the piping hardware and installation of the hydrant. We recently heard we have been awarded a FY 23 Fire-fighter Safety Equipment Grant from the Department of Fire Services (DFS). This grant will allow us to better protect our firefighters with upgraded personal protection equipment (PPE). Special thanks go to Theresa Thatcher, our department grant writer and Administrative Assistant.

Last winter, the Hampshire County Hilltown Fire Chiefs, led by Williamsburg Fire Chief Jason Connell, organized the first ever RIT (Rapid Intervention Team) training program in the hill towns. The course was led by experienced instructors from Williamsburg and Colrain FD's. The first class was held at the Dennis A. Thatcher Public Safety Complex here in Plainfield. Eventually, 9 firefighters from Cummington, Goshen, Plainfield and Williamsburg completed the 7-class training program in June. Plainfield FF's included Capt. Rob Shearer, Lt. Jamie Wooldridge and FF Dan Shearer. The training was strenuous and time consuming, but the skills learned could one day save a fellow firefighter or their own lives. It was great to be part of the start of such a high-level training program. My hope is that additional PVFD members will participate in the next RIT course taking place this spring.

We were able to put two more firefighters through the Hampshire County Fire Chief's Assoc. BASIC 6 fire training program. Two firefighters, Nate Wooldridge and Roscoe Weeks, completed the 6 weekend classes ending with a live fire class at the Sunderland FD Burn Building. Both these firefighters also turned 18 this past summer and became regular roster members of the PVFD. Asst. Chief Meehan continues to be an instructor at the Burn Building classes for the county.

This past October, the six Hilltown fire departments sponsored a fire training course that took place at our Public Safety Complex. The 10 hour/ 2 day course focused on "Fire Company Considerations: an exploration of skills and knowledge to assist firefighters, fire officers and chiefs on hill town firegrounds". The course was taught by Mendon, MA. Deputy Fire

Chief Joe Nedder, a nationally recognized fire instructor. Thirty firefighters from 8 departments attended the course, including 8 from the PVFD.

Fire and/or accident scenes are dangerous locations. This past Fall, Ashfield FD requested multiple mutual aid responses from the PVFD. The first incident involved a two-vehicle head-on collision at Rt. 116 and Pleasant St. The PVFD responded to assist Ashfield with an entrapped occupant. Four FF's, Asst. Chief Meehan, Capt. Hardwick, and FF's R. Weeks and C. DuPont, used our Power Hawk extrication system to free the victim. During their efforts, a Highland Ambulance paramedic determined the victim had died, and to stop further extrication efforts until a State Police Reconstruction Team arrived on the scene. In November, Ashfield FD again called the PVFD to assist them with an out-of-control brush fire threatening a structure. The call came at midday, a very difficult time to find firefighters able to respond. While attempting to put the fire out, Plainfield Highway Superintendent Walt Jennings, called to assist firefighters on the scene, was struck by a falling tree and sustained very serious physical injuries. He continues to recover. Responding to these incidents is not for everyone, but those who do respond to save lives and properties deserve huge support and respect.

Last summer, the Hampshire County EMS Committee hosted its annual Public Safety Awards night. Capt./EMT R. Shearer, LT. A. Stevens, EMT D. Stevens and Chief Alvord were awarded both Service and Save Awards at the event.

The requirements for maintaining an up-to-date Fire Department are continuing to grow. A list of annual required testing explains it best...

- EVOC Emergency Vehicle Driver Training course.
- Annual State Vehicle inspections for the department's 8 apparatus.
- Annual air flow testing for all 13 SCBAs (self-contained breathing apparatus).
- Annual "Fit Testing" for all interior trained FF masks.
- Annual CPR/Defib refresher for all roster members.
- Bi-annual EMT and 1st Responder refreshers for all members.

In addition to our ongoing training and testing, our fire apparatus continues to age and is becoming a concern. Our second engine, a 1992 Pierce 1000/1000, no longer passes NFPA pump testing requirements and is becoming increasingly more difficult to find parts for. This vehicle, the department's first out mutual aid apparatus is the last one the town has purchased without grant or PVFA assistance. It's been a great truck for the department, but the time is now to plan for its replacement. We hope the town's residents and property owners truly understand the need to replace the 31-year-old fire truck.

Respectfully submitted,
David Alvord. Fire Chief

Plainfield Fire/EMS 2021		Call Report: Total calls- 154	
MVA (motor vehicle accidents or assistance)	14	Mutual aid	3
Safety or traffic hazards	23	Medical/Trauma emergencies	57
Assist other town agencies	4	Haz. Material incident	1
Chimney fires	3	Fire investigations	
Fire/smoke alarms sounding	7	odor/smoke, etc.)	19
Brush fire	1	Fire Training/drills	9
Illegal outside fires	4	Fire inspections	2
Structure fire	1	Miscellaneous calls	6

POLICE DEPARTMENT

Through 2022 serving and protecting for the Plainfield Police Department meant responding to 1,098 calls registered through the 911 dispatch system. These are the calls listed on the monthly logs published in the Plainfield Post and posted on the Police Pages of the Plainfield Town Web Site. And about double that many calls are taken between the PPD office phone and officers' cell phones. Most of the Department's time is spent responding to these calls, patrols and investigations -- all primarily initiated by calls, requests and daily assessments of local activity.

We have been able to initiate a schedule of daily coverage that addressed concerns of gaps in coverage, especially on weekends. The full Staff Plan is also available for review on the Police Pages of the Town web site. With our SGT Anthony Gibbs working 4 days on, then 2 days off in rotation, most days are covered. Chief Litchfield generally works the early week day mornings and afternoons, to cover both commuting and school bus times, as well as address the growing bulk of administrative duties, many of which can only be done by our Chief. With a few hours available for our part-time officers this seems to allow for the most coverage we can provide with the resources currently available.

We have also been adapting to the new requirements of the POST era in police administration – Peace Officer Standards and Training. Although we have lost a few officers who could not meet the new requirements, we still have an active roster and are able to call upon several part-time trained and qualified personnel as our limited budget allows beyond the Chief and SGT Gibbs full time schedules. We are also part of a seven-town grant that provides a social worker response when and where this is a better option to respond to a crisis. We look forward and are working toward other cooperative arrangements with surrounding communities to share in the responsibilities and costs of public service.

We hope that by the time you read this report we will be inviting the public to review the renovations at the Plainfield Police station. As we move to quarters that will meet the needs and standards of a contemporary police operation like Plainfield's we look forward to the increased efficiency these renovations will make possible.

Again, on the Plainfield Town Web site you can see full contact information for the Plainfield Police Department. We will continue to respond to all calls, questions and concerns brought to the Department's attention. I would also like to thank the community for the support of the department, including the salary increases. It continues to be true that the community and officers support makes the challenges of serving and protecting a worthwhile and rewarding endeavor.

Respectfully Submitted,
Justin Litchfield, Chief of Police

HIGHLAND AMBULANCE EMS, INC.

Our call volume at Highland Ambulance has continued to increase at a fairly consistent rate. This is due in large part to our aging population as well as Covid, which continues to play a role in our numbers. Our new ambulance is performing well and we are in the process of ordering our next vehicle. By ordering now, we will save both money and time as ambulances are back ordered and harder to come by. With the support of our town's capital assessment fund and the donations from our citizens, we have a lot of the money we will need to move forward with this purchase.

As with most things, prices continue to go up but with the community support, we are able to continue to provide the highest level of care that our communities need and deserve. When you call 911 we will be there to answer your call.

Operations: Highland Ambulance is the primary ambulance service provider for the towns of Ashfield, Chesterfield, Cummington, Goshen, Plainfield and Williamsburg. Highland also provides primary back up in the town of Worthington in support of Hilltown Ambulance of Huntington. Paramedics are on duty at Highland's station in Goshen from 6AM until midnight seven days a week. During the hours of midnight to 6am, Highland is staffed with Basic EMTs and Paramedics are dispatched if required. Highland's active roster as of June 30, 2022 consisted of 21 members including 10 Paramedics and 11 EMT's. Our Service Director and Assistant Service Director are full-time paramedics and we are looking to hire one full time Paramedic to solidify our staffing pattern.

Highland's affiliate medical direction is provided by Cooley Dickinson Hospital. Dr. Peter Morse is our current Medical Director.

Mission: The mission of Highland Ambulance EMS, Inc. is to provide the full range of emergency medical services to our member communities. These services include: Providing training and certification for first responders. Developing and practicing emergency response plans with the schools and camps in member towns. Conducting health and safety classes for the schools.

Working with the Massachusetts Emergency Management Agency, (MEMA), the Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA), and Homeland Security to develop emergency response plans for member towns. Providing mutual aid and paramedic intercept services to the neighboring communities. Providing standby service for major emergencies such as structure fires. Providing standby service for major community events such as the Chesterfield Parade, the Ashfield Fall Festival and the Cummington Fair. Responding to all 911 calls that may require emergency medical services. Providing CPR programs to community members.

Emergency Responses: During FY 21/22, Highland responded to 1001 emergency calls. These calls are broken down by town:

Ashfield: 248	Chesterfield: 95	Cummington: 104
Goshen: 112	Plainfield: 81	Williamsburg: 287
Other: Mutual Aid Requests: 74		

Training: The following is a partial list of special training events held: Paramedic and Basic EMT recertification classes, CPR, First Responder classes, Surgical Airway class, Domestic Violence training, Scene Roles and Responsibilities, 12 lead ECG training, Advanced Cardiac Life Support and Ambulance equipment training.

Here are some of the ways Highland participated in our communities in support of them: Ashfield Fall Festival, Chesterfield 4th of July Parade, School safety programs, Junior Olympics and Chesterfield Gorge Road Race.

Operating Expenses in FY 21/22: \$828,734.75

Cash on hand June 30 2022:

Operating Fund: \$148,781.67

Ambulance Fund: \$21,279.55

Memorial Fund: \$45,620.57

Dresser Fund: \$4,104.49

Donations: \$272,288.36

Our 6 towns contributed \$430,021.88 of our total operations budget, based upon town assessments. The balance came from billings to insurance companies, Medicare, Medicaid, and generous contributions.

Respectfully Submitted,

Highland Ambulance Board of Directors:

Plainfield is represented by Edward Morann

BOARD OF HEALTH

In 2022 we were still dealing with Covid-19. Still dealing with it in 2023. This year the government gave us some masks and Covid test kits again.

We had a Flu vaccine and Covid Booster Clinic this year at the Thatcher Public Safety Complex.

On the other hand we still had our regular duties to accomplish: 5 Food service permit issues; 4 well permits, 5 septic system permits, 10 perc-test were done and 5 title5 inspections.

We received \$4,900 RDP ("Recycling Dividends Program") grant money award because we do a lot of recycling.

Recycling was a success in 2022. We are continuing to maintain an impressive recycling rate. The amount of cans, bottles and paper amounted to 33% of all of the materials brought in, not counting the textiles, books and electronics also recycled. The steady decline in compacter tonnage is also very encouraging. Increasing community interest in composting food waste and the Town and HRMC-subsidized Earth Machine composters for sale may help to partially explain the reduction in compacter tonnage. We lost two employees, Chris Wrobel who passed away and John Lydell, Chris's companion moved away. They will be missed.

We hired two hard workers: Henry (Hank) Horstmann from Conway and Heather Helms from Plainfield. They are doing a great Job. We can't forget about Jack Nelson he works as a volunteer and does a lot at the transfer station with the recycling and on the HMRC Board of Directors.

The Swap Shop we purchased with grant and Town funds was delivered May 16, 2023. It is working out great, stuff is going in and coming out. This helps reduce our recycling cost and saves on the land fill expense.

The Board of Health meets at the town hall the first and third Mondays of each month at 7 pm. On the board this year we had Respectfully Submitted, Ellen DuPont Ron Weeks and Dave Crowell

HIGHWAY DEPARTMENT

The mission of the Highway Department is to provide a safe, efficient, and productive operation of the department. The Highway Department strives for the professional community response with the environment, community, and budget.

The Highway Department provides essential duties throughout the community so residents and commuters have a safe worry-free experience while traveling. These daily activities include road maintenance, drainage, and of course winter activities.

The Highway Department deals with everything Mother Nature throws our way. Within the past year we have had several winter events, heavy rains, wind storms, and drought conditions. We continue to help other agencies including Fire, Police, and many more departments. Many incidents happen overnight including trees, washouts, and animal strikes.

Within the past year the Highway Department received a tractor from the Army Corps of Engineers. This tractor helped the Town out considerably. Many of the residents have seen it assisting with roadside mowing. The Highway Department also has taken over lawn maintenance, mowing and trimming. The areas that are maintained are the Public Beach, Town Hall, Town Offices, Internet Hub, Ball Field, Playground, Fire Station, and Police Station.

The purchase of a much needed Motor Grader was made possible with Chapter 90 funds. The Highway Department Also resurfaced roughly three miles of roadways. We had been awarded additional funding from WRAP (Winter Recovery Assistance Program). This funding nearly doubled our funding this year.

The Highway Department will continue to look for Grants and apply to such Grants. We will use these grants if awarded to repair and improve infrastructures throughout the Town.

I would like to thank the community for their support and concern from the accident I had suffered in November. The recovery process has definitely been challenging ,but the community helped me push through. In closing I would like to thank the crew in the Highway Department. The support from Town Offices, and the Selectboard goes without saying that it is greatly appreciated. I will continue to make improvements to the Town and Infrastructure moving forward.

Respectfully, Walter Jennings
Highway Superintendent

PLANNING BOARD

The Planning Board was Established by the Town of Plainfield according to Massachusetts Administration of the Government, Section 81A, and must consist of not less than five nor more than 9 members. In addition to conducting reviews of survey plans submitted for endorsement as not requiring approval under the subdivision control law, it is now charged with protecting the town's rural and historical character by the Granting of Special Permits. The Planning Board also continues with its projects reviewing the status of public ways in the town, advancing the pos-

sibility of a town green with improved parking and traffic flow between the Town Hall and the Congregational Church, and considering other possible zoning bylaw improvements.

Meetings: The Planning Board continued twice monthly meetings on the 1st and 3rd Wednesdays, online via Google Meet due to the pandemic, except for Special Meetings which were held live as required.

Town Roads Project: Arvilla Dwyer's notes on the history of many of the town's roads have been transcribed. The goal of this project is to identify ownership of the town roads and recommend changes to the status of some of these roads. Hopefully these will be finalized for presentation at a Town Meeting in 2024.

Conway School Planning Project: Prepared via a grant and working with the Planning Board, the completed A Climate Resilience Plan for Plainfield, covering Ecosystems & Biodiversity, Water Resources, Agriculture & Food Systems, Energy Systems and Community Infrastructure was approved by the Selectboard. The plan has been downloaded onto the town website and two copies were given to the library for residents use and information.

Approval Not Required (ANR): ANR's for 47 Jones Avenue, 208 South Central Street, 27 Broom Street and a property owned by Daniel K. Lederer & Amy Cullen were reviewed resulting in Approval Not Required.

Site Plan Review/Special Permits:

1. 29 Union Street, NEXAMP Special Permit Extension: Since the previously approved 2-year period to construct a Solar PV Installation didn't happen, NexAmp was required to hold another Public Hearing. They did and an amendment to their original Special Permit was approved.
2. 129/147 Grant Street for Marijuana Production Special Permit: Approved with conditions and a Notice of Decision was issued.
3. 47 Jones Ave Class 2 Used Car Dealership Site Plan Review: It was determined that the site has been in similar use since 1954 and although it is a non-conforming use, it would be grandfathered in. The Planning Board notified the Selectboard of this, recommending that their approval of the transfer of the license should be approved.

Special Permit and Site Plan Review Procedures: Developed and approved by the Planning Board, they were submitted to the Town Clerk for final approval and use.

Western MA Municipal Conference: One member of the Planning Board went to this conference attending an update on the police POST requirements and Public Infrastructure.

Village Green: A Stakeholders Meeting was held where the initial proposed site plan was presented along with a listing of the goals and objectives for the project. Questions from the guests were discussed and answered. Further development to continue.

Board Membership at year end was: Brian Hawthorne, Chair; Peter Lapointe; Judy Cole; and Kevin Green;. Brian Hawthorne announced he was resigning at the end of the year.

Respectfully submitted,
Brian Hawthorne, Chair

PLAINFIELD LIGHT AND TELECOMMUNICATIONS DEPARTMENT (AKA PLAINFIELD BROADBAND)

Plainfield Broadband oversees our town-owned broadband network that provides Internet and telephone service to any residence or business in our town. Whip City Fiber, a department of WG+E, provides Internet services (including telephone) and manages our network through an inter-governmental agreement between our two towns. We currently serve 282 residential and business customers, and the Town Hall, Town Offices/Library, Public Safety Complex, Highway Department, and Police Department buildings are connected to the network and each other.

Residential Gigabit Internet service is offered at \$85 per month with optional VOIP phone service at \$12.95 per month plus approximately \$9 per month in mandatory state and federal taxes and fees. A phone-only service is offered at \$49 a month. Most home-based businesses are covered under residential service rates. Costs for larger businesses, non-profits, and institutions depend on the number of users, the service level agreement needs of the business, and other factors. Business offerings range from \$100 per month to \$800 per month, and we can provide custom service pricing.

Our network is capable of serving every premise in town, with fiber optic strands on roadways that pass 100% of existing premises, including all dead-end roads. We are accepting new customers at any time. Our department will offset the costs to connect new residential service subscribers (up to \$1,000 for premises that have not yet been connected or up to \$500 for premises that have already installed fiber outside the home). We will provide price quotes for connecting new construction homes or businesses.

Accomplishments between January and December 2022 include:

- Continuing our work with the surrounding towns on our resiliency project to reduce the chances of major outages.
- Revised the Plainfield Broadband Installation Policy. The change is that newly constructed homes post 5/1/2018 will be entitled to the standard Installation up to \$1000 (must sign up for internet service, phone service optional).
- Continued Strong Fiscal Oversight, resulting in retained earnings in each of the last three fiscal years
- Actively Promoted Plainfield Broadband Services to reach as many households as possible.

We encourage you to visit the Whip City Fiber/Plainfield website (<https://www.whipcityfiber.com/plainfield>) or our page on the Town of Plainfield website for more information.

Respectfully submitted,

Lucas Sureaz-Orozco, Manager

PLAINFIELD ENERGY COMMITTEE (PEC)

In February 2017 the Massachusetts Department of Energy Resources (DOER) awarded Plainfield a \$137,575 Green Communities (GC) Designation Grant. We have spent a net of \$18,449 for LEDs

(Light Emitting Diodes) lighting upgrades on three town buildings and \$8,550 on consultants. The GC application required a goal of reducing our town's energy use by 20%. The LED lighting upgrades achieved 0.5% of that goal.

Since the designation grant can be used for solar photovoltaic (PV) but subsequent competitive grants cannot and since the town owns little open land, we focused on town roofs suitable for solar. The search narrowed it down to two locations: the Alden Pavilion and the back of Hathaway Hall. However the DOER did not approve these proposals.

Instead the DOER did approve \$102,473 to insulate the Hallock Building, the police station (formerly Hathaway Hall), and the town hall. These funds would also retrofit the Hallock Building with 3 air-sourced heat pumps (ASHPs). An Eversource incentive will provide an additional \$35,577 for the ASHPs.

ASHPs work like a refrigerator, using electrical energy to move heat from one place to another, far more efficient than generating the heat. In addition a heat pump has already been installed at the office in the highway garage with GC funds. The heat pumps at the Hallock Building are due to be installed by the end of February 2023.

These expenditures leave \$9,102 from the GC grant, which together with \$3,000 from a Direct Energy Solar gift during Solarize Plainfield, and possible money from the building committee, if approved by town meeting, could fund a heat pump at the police station. Although these heat pumps will lower our town's use of fossil fuels (oil and propane), they will increase the use of electricity and result in higher electric bills. This is why it is important for our town to have solar PV installations to keep our carbon footprint down.

The DOER has set a deadline of 31 May 2023 for all these projects to be complete.

Once the GC designation grant is spent, we hope to apply for a competitive grant to install heat pumps at the town hall. The PEC unanimously endorsed a non-binding measure on the November 2022 ballot that proposed a fee on the carbon content of fossil fuels (in order to combat global heating) with the proceeds to be returned as a cash-back to individuals.

Plainfield passed this measure by 62% while the 1st Hampshire state rep. district gave it 70%.

Massachusetts has provided generous incentives for home heatpumps. If homeowners install heat pumps for their whole house, the state offers a cash rebate of up to \$10,000 and a 7 year, 0% loan of up to \$15,000 for any remaining costs.

Before the Industrial Age, starting about 1750, there were about 278 parts per million (ppm) of carbon dioxide (CO₂), the main greenhouse gas that causes global heating, in Earth's atmosphere. In February 2021 CO₂ topped 417 ppm. By May 2022 it was up to 421 ppm, the highest in human history by over 100 ppm and the highest in the last 800,000 years. This is a 51% increase since the Industrial Age. These increases in CO₂ levels correlate with increases in Earth's atmospheric temperature. Every gallon of

gasoline that we combust dumps 19 pounds of CO₂ into the air. The CO₂ remains in the atmosphere for centuries.

It is important for people to understand the dire consequences of continued release of CO₂ and the resulting heating of Earth. The increased CO₂ and heat are a main cause of droughts, and, paradoxically, of floods since warm air holds more water, resulting in droughts, but dumps out more rain, causing floods. Global heating also melts the polar ice caps and glaciers, which causes sea level rise. The higher temperatures make some areas less habitable, which results in mass migrations. The increased heat also causes more intense storms and hurricanes and could affect crops and food supplies. Global heating is affecting everyone on Earth.

The PEC meets the 2nd Wednesday of each month at 7 pm by video conference to save energy from heating the town hall as well as saving travel time and energy.

Respectfully submitted,

Tim Walter, Chair

Conrad Liebenow, Matthew Stowell, Renee Schmidt,

Lyla Rozelle



SUPERINTENDENT OF SCHOOLS

The school districts have continued to focus on improving our technology infrastructure for in-person instruction through device replenishment and touch screen projection equipment. Every classroom in every school in Mohawk Trail Regional School District (MTRSD) now has a Clear Touch instructional projection device. In the Hawlemont Regional School District (HRSD), additional touch screens have been purchased and shared throughout the school. Our capital improvement projects in MTRSD have been completed. Again, thank you to the Capital Improvement Working Group for their time and thoughtful approach to ensuring our schools receive the needed attention and repairs necessary. We are excited to begin our solar project for MTRSD at the middle high school. While the project will create important savings in our operating budget, it will also generate green energy for the school. Thank you to our Outdoor Learning Committee for bringing this proposal forward and through completion.

We continue to advocate for the unique needs of students, families, and schools in our rural district and across the Commonwealth to sustain high quality, equitable education for our communities. We have worked with Representative Natalie Blais to ensure that the Rural Commission Report Recommendations are a key priority in legislation moving forward. We have support from the Massachusetts Association of School Superintendents, Massachusetts Association of School Committees, the Massachusetts Teachers Association, and the Massachusetts Municipal Association to advocate for the recommendations that would address the goals of the Student Opportunity Act beyond the initial phase of supporting districts and communities with substantial high need student populations.

Literacy continues to be a key focus area for both districts. Our District Literacy Leadership Team has chosen Wit and Wisdom for grades 7 and 8 and EL Education for Kindergarten through grade 6. Our work with the Hill for Literacy on the science of reading has continued as well as support from EL Education for implementation of our new curriculum. In addition, all elementary schools now have a common schedule so that students across the district have the same access to rigorous curriculum and instruction. We have continued our partnership with the Mary Lyon Foundation in support of our literacy focus, and extend our sincere appreciation for their collaboration.

We continue to implement our strategic plan and the four key priority areas designed to move our district forward. These priority areas include building community, innovating, investing in our shared future, and fostering an inclusive community of learners. HRSD has also developed a strategic plan to address the challenges and build on the unique and special nature of being a small rural elementary school. It's exciting to see the enthusiasm for our learning community. Our students are amazing athletes, musicians, artists, leaders, and friends and demonstrate what it means to be a Trailblazer: we are unique and our educational paths are filled with exploration, curiosity, individualized learning,

community involvement and deep connections. This is evident in so many areas of our districts. I continue to be extremely proud of our students, families, staff, and community as we have worked together to celebrate our learning community and look to the future to address the unique challenges facing our rural community. I look forward to continuing this collaboration in the years to come.

Respectfully submitted,
Sheryl L. Stanton, Superintendent

MOHAWK TRAIL REGIONAL SCHOOL

Feedback and Communication

Starting in January of 2022 I established routes for feedback and communication from all MTRS stakeholders. These included bi-monthly drop-in hours, a student advisory group, as well as quarterly How are we doing? Surveys to students, families and staff. These ongoing structures continue to provide opportunities for community members to give immediate feedback on what goes on at MTRS. In addition to the Local Educational Committee and the Outdoor Advisory Committee, these mechanisms also provide input into both the school and district improvement plans.

Barr funding and Innovation

In October of 2022 MTRS received \$160,000 from the BARR foundation. This represented the final payment for the grant awarded to support the continued redesign of Mohawk Trail Regional School. This payment has allowed us to continue to implement new initiatives and curricular programming to redesign the school experience for all students. Over the course of the past two years, students, staff, and community members have engaged in professional development and working groups in order to implement the new Trailblazer Model; Most recently seven teachers attended a site visit at Casco Bay School district to help inform and refine our model of teaching and learning:

Mohawk Trail Regional School is tailoring the most innovative work in the field of education to fit our rural district as we design the Trailblazer Model. We are building on the best of what we have while challenging the status quo to make education relevant and meaningful for our students. They will acquire 21st century skills while pursuing their individual passions, as they blaze a trail to graduation. Students will lead their own learning, break down the boundaries of traditional classes, and learn by doing. Experiences at MTRS will move our students beyond textbook knowledge. They will use research to solve real problems, intern at local businesses, design independent projects, and take courses at local colleges. In return, our community will flourish from the increased partnership with our school. MTRS graduates will be curious, adaptable, independent, and motivated citizens who seek to do good work in the world.

The Trailblazer Model has six key focus areas: high quality instruction, advisory and social emotions learning, communications and community outreach, distributed leadership, portfolios and equity. This model engages all stakeholders in a transformational school experience including:

Internships and work study opportunities, on campus and off
Interdisciplinary courses such as STEM, Bioethics, Artglish, and American Democracy
Social Emotional Learning supports including: Advisory model for all grades 7-12, site based therapeutic services, and college and career planning
Portfolio of student work
Senior Capstone project culminating with a site based internship
Community outreach including a Trailblazer Community Group comprised of staff, parents, students and community members that meets several times a year

We have continued to partner with national education organizations: Next Generation Learning Challenges (NGLC) and EL Education. NGLC and EL Education have been working with MTRS teachers and administrators to transform classrooms to be more student-centered and to develop rigorous and diverse ways in which students can demonstrate their learning. In addition, EL Education continues to assist teachers in the development of interdisciplinary, hands-on activities that will engage students in rigorous community-based projects. NGLC and EL have continued to support our Instructional Leadership Team and Portfolio Working Group to develop a comprehensive portfolio model and to prepare students to drive student-led conferences. Teachers will continue to guide students through the compilation of an individualized portfolio that demonstrates who they are as a learner and goals they set for themselves. NGLC and EL will also work with teachers to develop assessments that connect to 21st century skills and the real world.

In addition to EL Education and NGLC, MTRS has partnered with Firefly Worldwide Inc and their founder and CEO Cheyenne E. Batista. Ms. Batista continues to work with the MTRS Equity Council in their implementation of an anti-racism strategic plan with a focus on curriculum, communication, and policy.

Culture building

We continue to make significant community building strides as we “come back” after COVID-19. This intention is personified through the three slogans in the entry lobby at MTRS:

I am part of this community

I can contribute in a positive way

I will be accountable for my words and actions

We continue to focus on relationship strengthening and community building through our advisory program in 7-12 as well as regular student-led whole school assemblies on Wednesday mornings.

Distributed leadership and District-Wide structures

Distributed leadership continues to be evident through the work of the teacher based Instructional Leadership Team (ILT) and their work in designing and delivering staff PD on Standards Based Teaching and Learning development as well as piloting Student-led Conferences.

Academic structural changes have also come about as a result of a continued focus on student need, distributed leadership and helping support students returning to school from COVID-19. In the current school year, these include the creation of the role of

a District Literacy coordinator to help support the district focus on literacy and Middle school staff as they piloted EI and Wit and Wisdom ELA curriculum.

College and Career Supports

MTRS continues to focus on supporting students taking their learning beyond the classrooms. This is evident through the links that the Work based learning and Internship coordinator makes with Capstone students in grade 12 and also through the 7-12 project week in the late Spring semester.

In addition to our continued dual enrollment relationship with Greenfield Community College (GCC), we are pleased to be a partner in their Incubator grant, intended to increase student attendance in higher education in Franklin County. 2022/23 will see plans to work with GCC to provide more early college opportunities for MTRS students in grades 7-12.

Finally, we are incredibly grateful for the help and support of the Mary Lyon Foundation who secured a \$28,000 donation specifically to build a College and Career speakers center in the library. This was officially opened at the Open House in September Tiered Student Supports

Technology

This year has seen the district transition to SUZOR for software, hardware and school data management. Additionally, MTRS has invested \$130,000 in 34 Cleartouch devices for teaching and learning in all specialist classrooms.

Community Involvement

We continue to be thankful for parents and care providers for their active involvement in MTRS life through the Local Education Committee (LEC) and also the newly formed Outdoor Advisory Committee (OAC). The former is a great way to have family input and feedback on school improvement planning and the latter has been instrumental in providing community voices on how we continue to seek to use teaching and learning spaces and environment as effectively as possible. The OAC has been vital to helping develop our outdoor classroom and in helping the district with its solar panel project at MTRS.

Other community wide opportunities such as Open House, the Celebration of Learning and the Mohawk Trail Athletic Association (MTAA) organized Spring Fling continue to imbibe MTRS with positive community spirit.

Music and Theatre

We are really pleased with the resurgence of music and drama at MTRS in the past year. As well as a spring musical in 2022, Bits of Broadway, and a district Spring concert, Fall of 2022 saw two performances of Axe of Murder, our Winter play. Athletics

The Mohawk Trail Athletic Department has gone through a restructuring process in FY23 by hiring Ashfield's Greg Lilly to assume the role of District Athletic Director. In contrast to previous Athletic Directors, Mr. Lilly is now responsible for overseeing Mohawk Trail's athletic programs district wide, K-12. This change was made to ensure the health of our high school programs by investing time and resources into the sustainability of our youth and feeder programs.

This past fall, our West County Youth Soccer program had

187 participants from grades K-6 from our elementary schools. These are unprecedented numbers for a youth sports program in our district. Much of the credit for such high participation numbers goes to Ashfield's Tina Miller and Buckland's Jake Thurber, along with dozens of other coaches and volunteers who have worked tirelessly to give our students every opportunity to succeed on the pitch.

This winter also saw never before seen participation numbers in our Hilltown Basketball League! The district was able to field a total of 15 teams between our three elementary schools, Hawlemont, and New Hingham Elementary. All told, there were 158 elementary students playing hoops this past season. Also, for the first time in 4 years, Mohawk Trail was able to field a 5th and 6th grade Suburban travel team, coached by Shelburne's Fred Redeker and Buckland's Tim Budrewicz. This group had the opportunity to travel all over Western Massachusetts and face an extremely high level of competition.

At the Middle and High School levels, our athletes and teams have been struggling with low enrollment numbers. However, this has not prevented them from succeeding at the absolute highest level! Participation levels for athletics at Mohawk Trail are WELL above state and national averages and should remain that way for the foreseeable future.

This past fall, our Middle School Football team enjoyed an UNDEFEATED season, while also getting the opportunity to play night games under the lights on Pollard Field for the first time in history! In addition to this, our Volleyball, Girls Cross Country, and Boys Cross Country teams all qualified for the MIAA state tournament. All told, 7 of our 8 fall teams came away with winning records!

Both our Boys and Girls Alpine Ski teams are looking to continue a 40-year tradition of dominance on the slopes. The Boys are well on their way to another league championship, while our Girls are poised to repeat as STATE CHAMPIONS!

Another bright spot for the Mohawk Trail Athletic Department is the Girls Middle School basketball team! They suffered only two losses on the season while playing a schedule against high school competition! The future is very bright for our young women.

With the end of the pandemic, The Mohawk Trail Athletic Association has also seen a resurgence, and is always looking for volunteers to help coordinate its many fundraising efforts. The MTAA is the district's primary athletic booster, and aids our student-athletes by purchasing uniforms, athletic equipment, and anything else that our teams need to help them succeed! The future of Mohawk Trail Athletics is very bright, and our entire athletic family is working tirelessly to ensure it stays that way!

Student numbers

At the mid-point of the 2022-2023 school year, student enrollment in grades 7-12 is 286. Current enrollment numbers for middle school include approximately 73 students in seventh grade and 68 students in eighth grade. Enrollment for ninth grade is 42 students; 10th grade with 36 students; 39 members of the Junior class, and 26 MTRS seniors. We have 4 students enrolled in our post-graduate program.

Respectfully submitted,
Chris Buckland, Principal

PRINCIPAL SANDERSON ACADEMY

It is my pleasure to continue to serve as the Sanderson Academy principal. I would like to recognize the amazing commitment of the Sanderson Academy staff. Each day they support our students academically and social-emotionally. We continue to implement initiatives around our theme of health and wellness. We also implemented a new English Language Arts program this year.

Our enrollment as of the beginning of the 2022-2023 school year was 143 students in grades preschool through sixth grade. This is an increase of 17 students. The number of students at each grade level was as follows: 33 children in the preschool, 17 children in kindergarten, 13 children in first grade, 12 children in grade two, grade three had 13 students, fourth grade had 16 students, fifth grade had 22 students and 17 students were in our sixth grade class. All classes were grouped heterogeneously.

The faculty for the 2022-2023 school year consisted of ten full-time classroom teachers, one special education teacher, one full-time reading teacher and one full-time math interventionist/special education teacher. Specialists providing services in our school include a full-time school psychologist, a speech/language pathologist that services students four days per week, a full-time nurse, and occupational and physical therapists, each for less than one half day per week. Art, music, and physical education teachers provide instruction two days per week each. They provide students with one hour of class time weekly in each subject area. Students in grades 4-6 can participate in instrumental lessons. All classes also receive one class of Mindful Movement per week. We have a full-time library manager/media specialist who provides a lesson to each class one time per week. We have thirteen paraprofessionals. In addition, we have part-time before and after-school staff. The program allows students in grades preschool through sixth grade to receive supervision from 7:30 to 8:30 and until 5:30 each day for a daily fee.

During the summer of 2022, some building and grounds maintenance/repair was completed. A large portion of the parking lot was repaved. In addition, new concrete sidewalks were installed. Updates to the security system were also completed.

School safety remains a focus at Sanderson Academy. We have monthly fire drills. Firefighter Mike Purcell teaches a fire safety class to each of the grades in the fall. We conduct lock-down, evacuation, and shelter in place drills periodically. We appreciate the support of the Ashfield and Plainfield emergency personnel.

Lastly, on behalf of the Sanderson Academy staff and students, please accept a sincere appreciation for all the support we have received during the year. Thank you citizens of Ashfield and Plainfield for all you do to support your community school!

Respectfully submitted,

Emma Liebowitz M.Ed., Principal

SPECIAL EDUCATION AND PUPIL SERVICES

The Mohawk Trail Regional and Hawlemont Regional Special Education Department serve students in the Sanderson, Colrain, Hawlemont, Buckland-Shelburne, and Mohawk Trail Regional Middle and High Schools. The primary function is to ensure that students with an IEP (Individual Education Plan) or a 504 are being serviced at a level required to make effective progress with supports outlined in their IEP or 504. The Department of Pupil Services oversees special education, Title IX, Civil Rights, and ELL.

According to state data-

Mohawk Trail Regional 2021-22

Services provided to students are in several areas: speech and language, occupational therapy (OT), physical therapy (PT), counseling, academics, and English as a second language. The OT and PT spend about one day in each school. All schools have a full-time Speech Language Pathologist vs sharing an SLP and an assistant. This model changed two years ago to increase consistency and support for our students while being cost-effective. With an increased need for counseling services for all students, each school has begun to increase this level of support. BSE, Colrain, and Sanderson have a full-time school psychologist. Due to staffing, Hawlemont has a counselor and contracts out for psychological assessments. The Middle and High Schools have two full-time Adjustment Counselors (vs an additional guidance counselor) and School psychologist. The need for counseling support has increased dramatically and the ability for our students to access counseling in the community is extremely limited due to our location and size of wait lists. The level of services in each building is based on population, need, and level of services legally required by an IEP.

During the 2021-22 school year, we have returned to full in-person learning and are not serving students remotely. We do continue to offer virtual IEP meetings for caregivers, which supports their work-life needs. The district is legally obligated to support a SEPAC (Special Education Parent Advisory Committee). A small core group of parents began the process in the spring of 2021 to reinvigorate the SEPAC. At this time, both parents have stepped down because their students are no longer involved in special education. We will continue to seek out new parents to support the SEPAC. The district continues to support several substantially separate programs for students.

Students requiring the support of a BCBA (Board Certified Behavior Analyst): The program is located at BSE and currently serves seven students. When the program began, students spent more than 50% of their time within the program. Currently, those students are in their mainstream classes more than 80% of the time.

Mohawk Supported Classroom, located in the Middle and High School: The program supports students with social and emotional needs. Students receive educational support both in the program and within the general education setting.

The district has a program in the middle school that supports students with intellectual delays and requires a substantially modified program. Additionally, there is a vocational program at the secondary level that supports eligible students until they are 22. The goal of the program is to develop work habits and interests and support community-level jobs. Students participate in community job sites such as Berkshire East and Aubuchon. We are grateful to the local businesses for supporting our students.

Respectfully Submitted,

Leann Loomis, Director of Pupil Personnel Services

CARL H. NILMAN SCHOLARSHIP FUND

The Fund was established under the provisions of the Will of Carl H. Nilman for the purpose of providing scholarships. Recipients shall reside in the School District and be graduates of the Mohawk Trail Regional High School who desire and are deemed worthy of post high school education or training and who are in need of financial assistance.

This year (2022) the Awards Committee read 25 applications. 16 were from seniors and 9 were from graduates. We used 30% of our allotted monies for seniors and 70% for graduates. The Committee feels that seniors have multiple scholarship opportunities from other sources while graduates have fewer resources.

15 scholarships totaling \$10,775.00 were awarded to seniors and 9 scholarships totaling \$25,200.00 were awarded to graduates. Due to a decline in applications this year from both seniors and graduates we were able to award larger scholarships compared to previous years.

From 1991 - 2022 a total of \$1,130,800.00 has been awarded in scholarships. Mohawk seniors have received \$ 346,250.00 and \$784,550.00 has been awarded to graduates.

Students of any age who are graduates of Mohawk (and living in the nine-town area at the time of graduation) are encouraged to apply for scholarships to help meet their continuing education needs.

Applications are available either online or they can be obtained at Mohawk School. Please call Student Services at Mohawk, 413-625-9811, Ext.1503 for information regarding requirements and deadlines.

Respectfully submitted,
Marion E. Scott, Secretary

MARY LYON FOUNDATION

Innovative Support of Education 1990-2022

Fiscal Year 2022 (FY22) was a record year for the Mary Lyon Foundation. We exceeded our expectations in the silent phase of our Campaign for Student Success and raised \$2,082,635.69 toward our goal of \$5,000,000 over five years. Total campaign revenue since the Campaign began on October 1, 2020, is \$2,827,668.

The Campaign for Student Success is a bold initiative that allows us to invest in the most pressing needs facing our students, families, and educators.

The Mary Lyon Foundation is working tirelessly to ensure that all students come to school ready to learn, succeed academically, socially, and emotionally and thrive in the wider world. Our goal is to provide families with access to the services needed to foster a healthy and stable learning environment at home and school. We strive to ensure that Mohawk Trail and Hawlemont School District educators have the tools and resources they need to give our students the best possible education possible.

The Foundation's programming and services have expanded substantially in FY22 to meet the ongoing needs of our community.

Revenue and Expenditure Descriptions:

Special Projects: Donations the Foundation receives are

earmarked for other programs, such as the Buckland Recreation Department's Pool Project Career and College Counseling Center Scholarships: Scholarship funding received and established by the Mary Lyon Foundation paid out to Mohawk Trail Students. Unrestricted Endowment: Income from unrestricted donations is given to the Mary Lyon Foundation for use where needed most. Educator Assistance: Funding for educators in the Mohawk Trail and Hawlemont School Districts to support reimagination and innovation in the classroom.

Emergency Assistance: This category supports the Guardian Angel, Paulyne and Harper Gerry Student Assistant Funds. These funds support the family and children of the district by assisting with groceries and clothing, avoiding shut off of utilities, etc.

Literacy: Funding to support literacy in children from birth through high school.

Operations: Annual fundraising to support the Mary Lyon Foundation's daily operations.

Restricted Endowments: Income from restricted endowments underwrite the Mary Lyon Foundation's programs, services, and scholarships in perpetuity. (e.g.) Student Assistance, Emergency Assistance, Literacy, and Educator Assistance.

Campaign Fundraising: Unrestricted funding for immediate use where it is needed most.

Respectfully submitted,
Kristen Tillona Baker Executive Director

SHAW MEMORIAL LIBRARY

The Shaw Memorial Library is a member of the Western Massachusetts Regional Library System. Which allows us to order books, cds, and dvds thru interlibrary loan. We have a delivery weekly. Any titles that we don't have can be ordered through this service. It sure helps us small libraries to get materials that we don't have for patrons.

We have had a fairly good year. We have seen our circulation increase with more patrons starting to use the library again.

We welcomed Linda Mason as our newest library trustee member.

We put up a reading trail on the front lawn. We had our annual book sale Labor Day weekend. In August we started having story hours for the kids. We did a craft project following the book themes being read. We had storyteller Davis Bates, (*Parents Choice Award-Winning Singer & Storyteller*) come to do a lively program called "Halloween Harvest". Many songs and stories were much enjoyed.

In November we had Plainfield author Alice Schertle come to read her newest little blue truck book, "*Little Blue Truck Makes A Friend*". This was well attended with many coming from all surrounding towns. For December we had four different craft projects to be made and taken home. We also provided a snack with hot chocolate.

Thanks to "The Friends of the Shaw Memorial Library" the library has the following Museum Passes for our patrons to

borrow: MASS MoCA, The Clark Museum, the Norman Rockwell Museum as well as the Massachusetts State Park Pass.

LIBRARY HOURS: Tuesday: 2:00 - 8:00, Thursday: 5:00 - 8:00
Saturday: 9:00 - 12:00

Respectfully Submitted:

Denise Sessions Library Director

Donna Monroe, Sandy Morann, Linda Mason

CULTURAL COUNCIL

The Plainfield Cultural Council, a local arm of the Massachusetts Cultural Council, has the primary task of reviewing applications for the state funds awarded to our town for granting. The Council also presents ArtsFeast at the September Firefighters' barbecue. This year, we also conducted our own project designed to support pollinators in our town.

In the summer, the Council conducted a workshop for children on building shelters for bee species that winter over in the stems of dried plants. The workshop was not well-attended in spite of being amply publicized. The materials were then displayed and sold at ArtsFeast. Project funds were used to rent a tent at ArtsFeast, allowing artisans selling work to be outdoors with the other barbecue activities. The indoor library room became a gallery for the viewing of fine art. A special display was created to honor Gene Flores, a notable Plainfield artist who had recently died. The Council reserved funds to repeat this expansion of ArtsFeast, and will honor a living notable artist next fall.

The grant program went well, with the transition to direct granting (funds provided prior to the completion of projects) proceeding fairly smoothly. It was a bit confusing to recipients, however, as other towns in our region remained on the old system. As the dust of the Covid postponements and cancelations cleared, the Plainfield Cultural Council had leftover funds at its disposal. The granting process in late 2022 thus allowed many projects to be funded, many of them in the entire amount sought.

The current members of the Plainfield Cultural Council are Kathryn Jensen, (Chair), Elaine Sidney, Ellen Baer, Barbara Westwood, and Lina Bernstein. We welcome new members.

Respectfully submitted,
Kathryn L. Jensen

PLAINFIELD CONSERVATION COMMISSION

Each town and city in Massachusetts has a Conservation Commission, which is charged with protecting the town's wetlands resources under the Massachusetts Wetlands Protection Act (1972) (General Law Chapter 131, Section 40). This law (www.state.ma.us/dep) prohibits the removal, dredging, filling or altering of wetlands without a permit. Residents planning construction or alteration on their property should contact a member of the Plainfield Conservation Commission for a Request for Determination (RDA) to determine if their property falls under our jurisdiction. We will inspect your property and issue a positive or

negative determination. A negative determination which implies there is no negative impact, states that the area/work does not fall under our jurisdiction, approves resource area boundaries, or approves alternative analysis. Under some negative determinations the project may go forward but certain conditions might apply. A positive determination indicates that the area/work does fall under the jurisdiction of the Act and therefore a Notice of Intent must be completed and submitted to the Conservation Commission and Department of Environmental Protection. The members of the Plainfield Conservation Commission work with property owners to insure that all interests are addressed.

The Plainfield Conservation Commission's regularly scheduled public meetings are held on the last Wednesday of each month, as needed, at 6:30 PM in the Town Hall or online as a ZOOM Meeting. The Commission's usual business includes reviewing applications for building permits and forest cutting plans in order to ensure compliance with the Wetlands Protection Act (1972) and the more recent Rivers Protection Act (1996). Members of the Commission also make site visits to help property owners identify possible resource areas and buffer zones. The Commission also serves an educational role for the community. Members attend workshops on conservation issues and can in turn serve to raise community awareness of the benefit of Plainfield's wetlands and forests.

During 2022 The Plainfield Conservation Commission conducted the following business:

Public Hearings:

- 27 South Union St. NOI approved 10/26/22
- Eversource Lines 1231, 1232 NOI approved subject to conditions 6/29/22

Public Meetings:

- A public informational meeting on a proposed local wetlands bylaw was held on April 27, 2022.
- 10 Prospect St. an RDA was presented by Kirsten Barringer for landscaping. The Con Com issued a negative determination under #2 that does not require the filing of an NOI.
- 678 West Main St. replacement of a deck, negative determination under #2

Made Site Visits to:

- 10 Prospect St. by Erik, Judy, Jack, Judith & Alice to review a landscape design presented by Kirsten Barringer for David & Bettie Briggs.
- 73 West St. by John, Erik, Alice, Jack & Judith for construction of an equipment enclosure. There were no jurisdictional issues.
- 76 North St. Judy, Jack, and Erik There were no wetland issues
- 39 Bow St. Archie Bardwell by Judy, no wetland issues
- 156 East Main St. Thibault property, 5/27/22 no wetland issues
- 27 South Union, Laurie Israel & Elaine Sydney, 6/15/22
- Eversource lines 1231, 1232 visit by Judy, Judith, Erik & Jack 6/15/22
- 196 Prospect Judy, Judith, Erik & Alice, 30 acre property

- with potential buyer 6/15/22
- 678 West Main, by Erik, Jack, John, & Judith 7/20/22
- River Road Plot 27/25 by Alice, Jack, Erik, Judy & Judith, property owner Kyle Dempsey and consultant Joe Rogers, also attended, 9/21/22

Other Business:

- A Certificate of Compliance was issued to Joe Rogers for Eversource Energy Line 312 on Jan. 26, 2022
- Highway Superintendent, Walter Jennings received a negative response from the Dept. of Transportation for repair of a culvert damaged by beavers on Route 116. They suggested hiring a professional consultant to assess the problem and cost of repair. Feb. 23, 2022
- Walter Jennings reported that a grant has been received to install a beaver deceiver on private property on West Hill Road 1/26/2022
- 76 North St On May 10, 2022 an enforcement order was sent to Jared LaRoche requiring him to cease and desist all activities in wetlands and buffer zone and to attend a meeting of the Con Com. On June 1, 2022 Mr. LaRoche's restoration plan was approved by the Con Com. He had met the requirements of the Enforcement Order.
- Lot 14 Bow & Alden St. An enforcement order was sent to Greg & Aly Miller for removing vegetation within the river front and buffer zone May 12, 2022. The Plainfield building inspector and Board of Health have sent notices to vacate premises because of violations. This ongoing problem is now in the hands of the court.
- A Certificate of Compliance was issued to Joe Rogers for River Road Plot 27/25 9/28/22
- Plainfield Pond Presentation by Ed Stockman resulted in the formation of Friends of Plainfield Pond 8/31/22
- Wetland Workshop by Mark Stinson in Charlemont attended by Jack, Erik, Judith & Alice
- Signs of Emerald Ash Borer tree infestation reported & confirmed near 208 South Central

Respectfully submitted: Erik Burcroff, John Burns,
Judith Williams (Chair) Judy Ferber, Jack Nelson,
Alice Schertle,

AGRICULTURAL COMMISSION

Agricultural Commissions in Massachusetts, unlike several other commissions which are part of local town government, have few state mandates, requirements, or even guidelines to direct their activities. The one direction from the state is to work for the preservation of agricultural lands and to support agricultural enterprises in that town. For a number of years Plainfield Ag. Comm. has worked off the guidelines outlined in our local Right-to-Farm By-Law, passed in 2003. However the By-Law does not give us legal authority to enforce guidelines or decisions although it does mandate that we will serve as mediators in disputes involving agricultural issues. The other piece of guidance written by the Agricultural Commission in 2017 is the "Resolution endorsing the

protection of pollinators and enhancement of pollinator habitat". For enforcement we consult with various town Boards such as Zoning, Health, and the Conservation Commission.

The Right-to-Farm By-Law encourages "responsible" farming practices, a necessarily vague definition to allow for various forms of farming while discouraging damaging methods. Unfortunately much of conventional agriculture has proven "irresponsible" to the environment. Many of our widely accepted modern practices in both field and yard have been disastrously damaging to insects, the keystones of the environmental arch supporting everything. Although we usually think of bees and butterflies visiting summer flowers when we say "pollinators" we are forgetting the huge variety of insect and animal life which makes much of agriculture viable. We are also ignoring the year-round necessity of protective habitat and useful food sources. Hence, our concentration on pollinator preservation, including their habitat. Two of the Ag. Comm.'s primary efforts in both 2021 and 2022 involved these goals of preservation. We headed the successful effort of the town to opt out of the state mosquito spraying program which would adversely affect not only mosquitoes but most other insects, small animals, and humans either directly or indirectly. We continue work on the demonstration pollinator garden along with accompanying educational programs and articles.

We also co-sponsored the Tree Alliance's Arbor Day planting of community street trees. With funds requested by the town Tree Warden we planted a dozen native street trees., mainly in the historical district of town. In 2021 the tradition of trees planted in memoriam was started with native trees planted in memory of the sons of two members of the PTA, one the chair of the Ag. Comm. The Ag. Comm. was one of the town entities to consult with the students from Conway School formulating environmentally friendly plans for future town development. Thanks to zoom several of our members have provided testimony and/or support to various relevant state hearings and bills and the whole Commission has signed letters of support to several state environmental bills. We also support and share expertise with the Massachusetts Pollinator Network, a subgroup of NOFAMass (Northeast Organic Farmers' Association). The work of the Ag. Comm. is frequently cited in public educational panels presented by the statewide Pollinator Network. Our experience as one of the first towns to pass a pollinator habitat protection resolution, our educational efforts to grow public knowledge about both the crisis and helpful methods of gardening, and the development of an inclusive public plan to fulfill the state requirements for opting out of the spraying program have been used through these forums to help other towns achieve similar projects.

2022 saw the beautiful maturation of the pollinator garden at the town post office. Its bounty was immediately evident as single plantings done in 2021 produced such a proliferation of volunteer seedlings that we sponsored a plant sale. It was unexpectedly very successful and gathered a lot of interest in both the garden and in using these and other native plants in private gardens around town. We are using that money to add more things to the garden. Ed Stockman, a longtime member of

the Ag. Comm., planted his simple homemade beehouse block in the garden. Jack Nelson gave us a workshop on straw figures like last year's Ariel who has gone on to other activities. Our own creation will be making its appearance in 2023. One of the most successful activities at the garden was the work party with "Shire for Hire", a group of enthusiastic campers from Shire Village who helped with garden jobs while learning about the needs and benefits of pollinators, preserving needed year-round habitat, and how to carry on this work after they go home. (see project page) Here is the happy group at the end of their work day.

The Agricultural Commission followed the state requirements, submitting Plainfield's request to the MA Office of Energy and Environmental Affairs (EEA) to opt out of any mosquito spraying that may have been conducted by the State Reclamation and Mosquito Control Board (SRMBC) during the 2022 mosquito season. The application process was marginally simpler than in 2021, with fewer requirements. Received signed approval of the opt out application from the Selectboard which was later accepted by the State.

In our mandated role as mediators in an on-going dilemma to fairly resolve the civic disturbance caused by a noise cannon used on a local farm, we facilitated a meeting between the farmer and the person representing those disturbed residents. (This occurred in January 2022 after compiling complaints from the summer of 2021 and researching possible alternatives.) We discussed several of these solutions and how to conduct future communications between the farmer and affected residents. These were tried during the summer of 2022 but proved unsatisfactory. Numerous complaints were fielded by our Commission during June-August of '22 and contacts made with the farmer. Following the noise ordinances in the By-Laws of the town Zoning Board we referred the issue to the town Building Inspector who is the legal enforcer of the zoning laws. This process is continuing into 2023. We hope to have the issue satisfactorily addressed by the Building Inspector before the growing season this coming spring and definitively resolved by the months when a wildlife pest deterrent is used by the farmer to protect his crops.

Respectfully submitted,
Anna Hanchett

TREE WARDEN

The Town Tree Warden is responsible for the protection and planting of street trees, as provided for in Massachusetts General Law Chapter 87, AND for the removal of dead or dying street trees that pose a potential hazard to the public. The Tree Warden budget for fiscal year 2023, which ends June 30, 2023, is \$ 10,000 for tree removal and \$ 2000 for tree plantings.

During the summer and fall of 2022, the following activities have resulted in the removal and trimming of street trees deemed to be hazardous and the planting of new set-back trees:

1. Eversource continued to complete their plan for the removal of street trees in Plainfield that have a potential to impact the re-

liability of their power lines, as previously agreed to by the tree warden and the Eversource arborist.

In addition, Eversource engaged in a tree trimming program along power lines in Town, resulting in the removal of several dead standing street trees as approved by the tree warden. This work benefited the Town by removing dead or dying street trees at the Utility's expense.

2. The Town of Plainfield contracted for the removal or trimming of 10 street trees which were determined to be hazards. This work was completed in the Fall of 2022.

3. In April 2022, with the help of the Plainfield Tree Alliance and many volunteers, 15 setback trees were planted with the permission of adjacent property owners, along town roads within 20 feet of, but outside the roadway rights-of way. Another similar tree planting program is scheduled for this April.

Respectfully Submitted,
Robert E. Mellstrom, Tree Warden

COUNCIL ON AGING

The Council on Aging Board gained three new board members this year, Polly Ryan as the Coordinator, Bonnie Phillips, and Mary Potter. Our long-standing members, Shirley Todd, Susan Honneus and Ann Irvine remain. Susan Pearson is on medical leave and Linda Carver resigned in May. We have held board meetings every second Wednesday of each month, the same day we provide in-person luncheons.

We are pleased to have been able to have more activities this year as Covid restrictions lessened. Luncheons, provided mostly gratis by board members, resumed in March. Our monthly average attendance was 22 people. We also provided a Veteran's luncheon on November 11th with 20 attendees.

For fun and to reduce isolation several events were planned. In August, a Connecticut River cruise and luncheon on the Lady Bea boat afforded 28 residents a memorable time. Every fourth Thursday of each month through October we opened Town Hall for a "Game Playing" social gathering. In September, we hosted a multi-generational event with Sergei Isupov at the Project Art Studio in Cummington learning how to make clay mugs. The Ashplain Players also serenaded us with a free concert after our luncheon in September. Our Christmas dinner was followed by a caroling sing-along facilitated by John Burns. A big thanks goes out to Phil Allesio work cooked this years Thanksgiving Turkey and the Christmas roast beef for our holiday luncheons.

Our new Coordinator, Polly Ryan, has strived to address health and food security concerns for residents this year. In October, she arranged a Covid and Flu vaccine clinic that over a hundred people participated in! She also signed up for a walking challenge offered through the Massachusetts Council on Aging to introduce residents to the "Plainfield Walks" trails. She continues to promote exercise classes with Joan Griswold via Zoom and in-person "Healthy Bones and Balance" classes with Jill Abrahamsen in Cummington. She also trained to become a "Dementia Friends Champion" and will be offering monthly support sessions throughout 2023 for anyone impacted by this condition and their caretakers. On the food security front, she has teamed up with the Cummington COA Coordinator to offer bi-monthly Grab and Go meals

provided through Highland Valley Elder Services and advertised The Hilltown Mobile Market. Foot Care clinics are also coordinated through the Cummington COA for Plainfield residents.

Polly also aims to provide informative talks on issues of concern to elders like Medicare insurance, legal matters, and financial benefits for low-income residents. She invited the local SHINE (Serving the Health Insurance Needs of Everyone) representative, Deb Hollinsworth, to speak after a luncheon in November about the Medicare open enrollment process. Mass Save also came to speak after a luncheon about their energy cost savings programs and the new incentives available around buying heat-pumps in the Inflation Reduction Act.

Every first Wednesday of the month, Polly attends the Northern Hilltown COA Consortium meeting in Chesterfield. This has been an invaluable resource for learning how other COA Coordinators help seniors in their towns. There are two major concerns the Consortium has worked on this year as a group, one being securing future funding for the monthly COA newsletters that goes out to seven Hilltown's and the other is deciphering the technology needs of elders and obtaining funding for continued technology support. Peg Whalen will be offering one-on-one technology support through June of 2023 after our monthly luncheons which is funded by a Consortium grant. The COA newsletters have been funded by an EOE (Elder Offices of Elder Affairs) grant which is due to end June 30th, 2023. Our last consortium meeting involved speaking with State representatives about the importance of this continued support in the State budget. Should this resource go away, it would severely impact elders in our community as it is the major way to communicate all the resources the COA provides. It's been estimated that it would cost each town \$5,000 to publish their own newsletter and this does not include any consideration for the people needed to complete the task. In addition, putting out the newsletter as a consortium allows us to include a regional section that informs our seniors of events and benefits offered in the other Hilltown's.

The Plainfield COA would like to extend the services we provide in 2023 by continuing to provide information on "Aging Gracefully in Place" while staying connected with community and having some fun. Past town budget allocations have provided funding for a Plainfield COA Coordinator to serve the community 10 hours per week, which is sufficient at this time. However, this does not leave left over funds to pay for events. Presently, we rely solely on donations for this. It would go a long way to have a couple extra thousand dollars to fund events in our 2023-2024 town budget.

Respectfully submitted,

Polly Ryan, Plainfield Council on Aging Coordinator.

BUILDING COMMITTEE

Since the annual report comes out in the spring every year, the Buildings Committee going forward will file the report based upon the calendar year. This will allow for more timely reporting when the reports are available and for this reason, this report covers an 18 month period.

We were able to bid the roof replacement for the Highway Garage in the fall of 2021 (first quarter of FY 2022) and we received only one bid that was over three times our budget of \$50,000 appropriated several years earlier at annual town meeting. The roof leaks seem to have been minimized since the wood furnace has failed and is no longer in use. Likely ice damming contributed to leaks. As a result, the build-

ing committee has researched other alternatives including a liquid applied roofing membrane. These systems are typically proprietary with licensed installers and this doesn't dovetail neatly with procurement laws requiring competitive bidding with multiple products and vendors.

We have been working closely with the energy committee to implement projects using the designation grant from the Green Communities program. The landscape of that program has changed with a priority for energy conservation measures rather than alternative energy in the form of solar panels. This led to warrant articles at the last town meeting to fund contingencies for projects at the town hall and town offices. Even within those parameters, contractors pricing changed and the scope needed adjustment. This is still evolving and we continue to work to maximize the benefit of this grant to the town's energy profile

Moving forward, the committee continues to juggle the need to address repairs within our budget and fund deferred maintenance projects when we have the resources to do so. We are able to do minor repairs when needed and continue to need unscheduled maintenance on the systems that are aging in all of our buildings.

We have been unsuccessful finding a candidate for the handyman position to do minor repairs despite having funding to fill that position. Multiple small repairs remain uncompleted as a result. This is both frustrating and perplexing since it requires the committee to react to emergency repairs rather than scheduling deferred maintenance.

Our two capital projects to replace the town hall fire escape and provide improvements for the police department have been stalled in part due to Covid work restrictions, inflation related to Covid and the need for professional services for permitting. This continues to be a priority and we are committed to find a path forward. Construction prices remain in flux and public procurement processes exclude many local contractors. We have had contractors withdraw proposals or decline to submit proposals.

You may have noticed the removal of the town message board this fall. We started to recondition it and found the panel was beyond repair. We are in the process of constructing a replacement and it should be completed before you read this report or soon thereafter.

We welcomed a new committee member, Kathryn Jensen, in September and now have a full 5 member committee.

Peter Lapointe, Chairman

Jeff Prost, David Alvord

UPPER PIONEER VALLEY VETERANS SERVICES

Mission Statement: To advocate for veterans, their spouses, dependants, widows or widowers for Veterans' Benefits on the Local, State and Federal levels

- Office has maintained continued outreach operations across the district. We have dramatically increased the amount of VA claims we have been completing due to increased VA Presumptive diseases for numerous eras of service:
- District now brings in \$1,850,500.00 in Federal and State money per month from all sources (VA, State Reimbursements, State Annuities and sales).
- Tim Nijadlik retired in October of 2022, with Chris Demars

taking over as Director.

- VSA Laura Thorne has maintained her SHINE certification and is helping veterans and their dependents, taking some of the load off the Senior Centers. Brian Brooks, Veteran Service Officer, was named the Massachusetts Marine Corps League Commandant, representing Marine Veterans across Massachusetts for the second year in a row.
 - Office participated in numerous protests against potential VA closures, this seems to have helped along with our local elected officials in keeping VA Leeds open for now.
 - We project a slight increase for Fiscal Year 24 budget while continuing to expand services in 2023
- Respectfully submitted,
Christopher Demars, Director
Upper Pioneer Valley Veterans' Services District

VETERANS GRAVES OFFICER

There were two beloved Plainfield residents, who were Veterans, that passed away in 2022. David Wood and Jay McMahon. 223 flags were placed on the veterans' graves in the Hilltop Cemetery, in the West Hill Cemetery, and on the Veterans' Memorial in front of the Plainfield Congregational Church. As required by State Law, the flags are set before Memorial Day, and are removed after Veterans' Day to prevent them from becoming frayed and faded during the winter.

Respectfully submitted,
Michael Melle, Veterans' Graves Officer

CEMETERY COMMITTEE

During 2022 there were 11 cemetery plots sold in the Hilltop Cemetery on North Central St. There were several cremation burials and one full earthen burial at the Hilltop Cemetery in 2022. Spring clean up was completed at both the Hilltop and West Hill Cemeteries. The two cemeteries were mowed and trimmed four times during the season.

Mowing and cleanup is done by Mert Taylor, Sr. Flags are placed on the graves of veterans before Memorial Day. Dudley Williams has given up this task and it is now passed to Michael Melle. Thank you to Dudley for his past service and a thank you to Michael for stepping up to place the flags.

Respectfully submitted,
Ruth Osgood, Burial Agent, Mert Taylor, Theresa Thatcher

THE HILLTOWN RESOURCE MANAGEMENT COOPERATIVE

The Hilltown Resource Management Cooperative (HRMC) was created in 1989 by a group of dedicated volunteers who had the vision to seek a regional solution to help small towns attain sustainability and environmental objectives through solid waste and recycling programs.

HRMC services included:

- Conducting annual DEP transfer station inspections and work as a liaison between Towns & MADEP on transfer station compliance matters.
- Hired New Administrator, Linda Cernik
- Established New Regional Mattress Recycling "HUB".
- Introduced New Recycling within the Textile Services.
- Introduced "Green Team" Mass DEP Program.
- Execution of an annual Household Hazardous Waste Collection event.
- Program management of transfer station recyclables including collection, hauling and recycling of tires, electronic waste, universal waste (including free recycling of mercury thermostats and re-chargeable batteries), books, and Freon evacuation.
- Outreach on transfer station operations and recycling initiatives.
- Submittal of member-Town DEP annual surveys, grant applications, and reports.
- Financial administration of HRMC programs and services.

The day to day business and program operations of the HRMC are managed by a contracted Administrator, who also serves as a representative to the Springfield Materials Recycling Facility (MFR) Municipal Advisory Board the State Solid Waste Advisory Committee, the Western Mass Regional Recycling Coordinator group; and, interfaces with local, regional, and State officials, and Mass Recycle Board member. HRMC Board meetings are held on alternate months.

The HRMC has an annual operation's assessment that is approved by each Town at their annual Town meeting. The annual Assessment Budget is based on tonnage and population. In FY22, the combined assessment for all ten towns was \$ 67,540. The Assessments offset base operating expenses. HRMC recycling program collection costs are pass-thru expenses from the HRMC to the Towns to best maximize economy of scale and to enable the HRMC administrator to have review and oversight of vendor relations and program operations.

In 2022, all HRMC member-towns were eligible for and received Recycling Dividend Program Grants under the DEP Sustainable Materials Recovery Program (SMRP). Applications were submitted for them through the HRMC. In total, the HRMC Towns received \$ 52,500 in grant funds to be used to further enhance recycling programs. Plainfield was awarded \$5,950. The Town Also received SMRP grant for a "Swap Shop". Re-cycle ~ Re-use stop by and see what treasures you may find! The Swap Shop accepts gently used household items, "The New Plainfield Mall".

During the past year, the HRMC member-Towns collectively diverted 846 tons of recyclable materials to the MRF; the Town of Plainfield recycled 40.33 tons in 2022. Eight of the ten member-Towns have adopted recycling goals of 50% with the intent of increasing quantity and improving the quality of materials being recycled at their transfer stations and to reduce waste being landfilled. In 2022, the Town of Plainfield had a recycling rate of 45% compared with 33% in 2021

Respectfully submitted,
Linda Cernik, HRMC Administrator

